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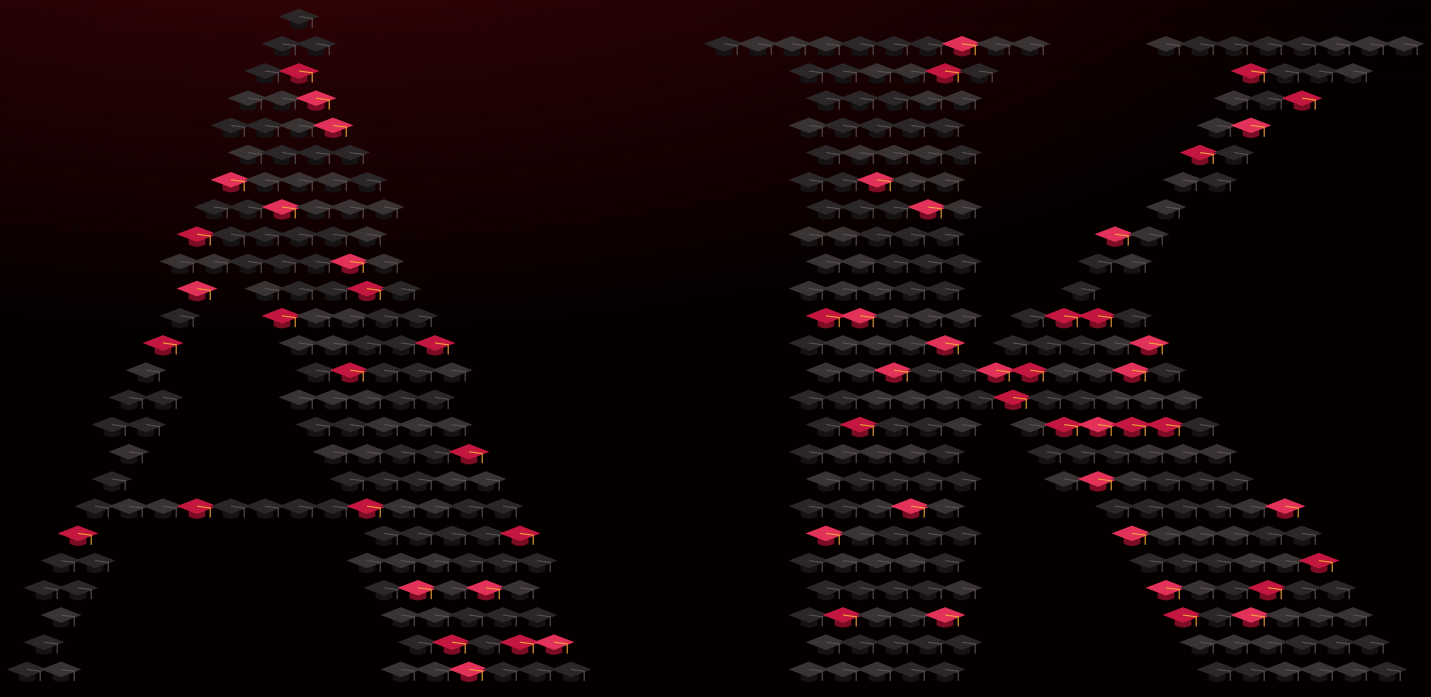
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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Alaska Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **16 in every 100**, mark the international share of Alaska's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 Alaska Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Alaska: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Alaska Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Alaska's numbers say

1. **International students earn 16% of Alaska's STEM master's degrees,** 36.5 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 47th of 51 on dependence. The share is 9.1% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 2.6% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Alaska awarded 10 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.0% of the U.S. total and 51st of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed −44%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **Among states of similar size,** Alaska ranks 4th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Alaska 16%, Wyoming 37%, Vermont 9.6%, Montana 18%, North Dakota 36%.
4. **77% of Alaska's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 1.1% came from abroad. More residents left for other states (1.8K) than students arrived from them (668), a net loss of 1.13K; the top destination for those leaving was Arizona.

16%

of the STEM master's degrees Alaska awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

22.7K #51
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −28% since 2015

10 #51
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K**

16% #47
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +1.7 pp since 2015

6.0% #46
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · 0.0 pp since 2015

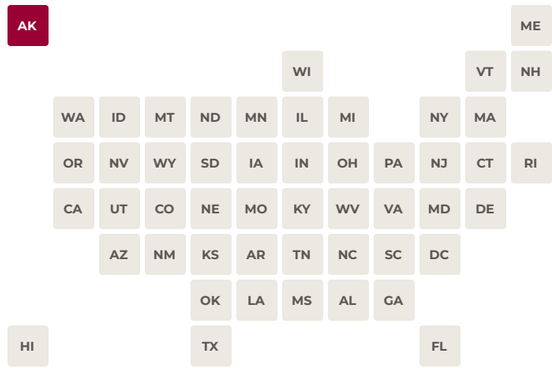
22% #31
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · −1.4 pp since 2015

31% #51
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +0.4 pp since 2015

$28K #2
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +5.1% since 2015

77% #14
First-time students from in state, 2024
−14.9 pp since 2016

$90K #34
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −16% since 2016



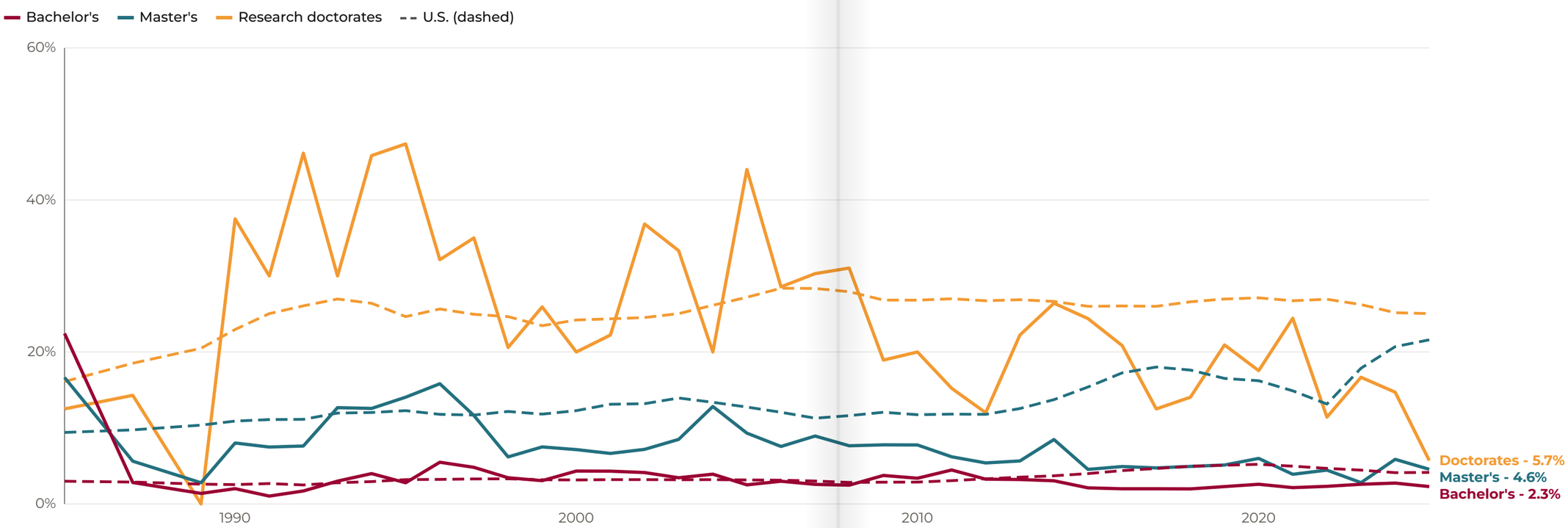
Badges give Alaska's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Alaska ranks 48th of 51 on the international share of all master's, at 4.6% in 2025 against 22% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of Alaska's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 6.0% of Alaska's graduate enrollment and 1.2% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 2.3% of bachelor's, 4.6% of master's and 5.7% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 2.6% of STEM bachelor's, 16% of STEM master's and 9.1% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.0% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 51st of 51.

6.0%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **46th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

4.6%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

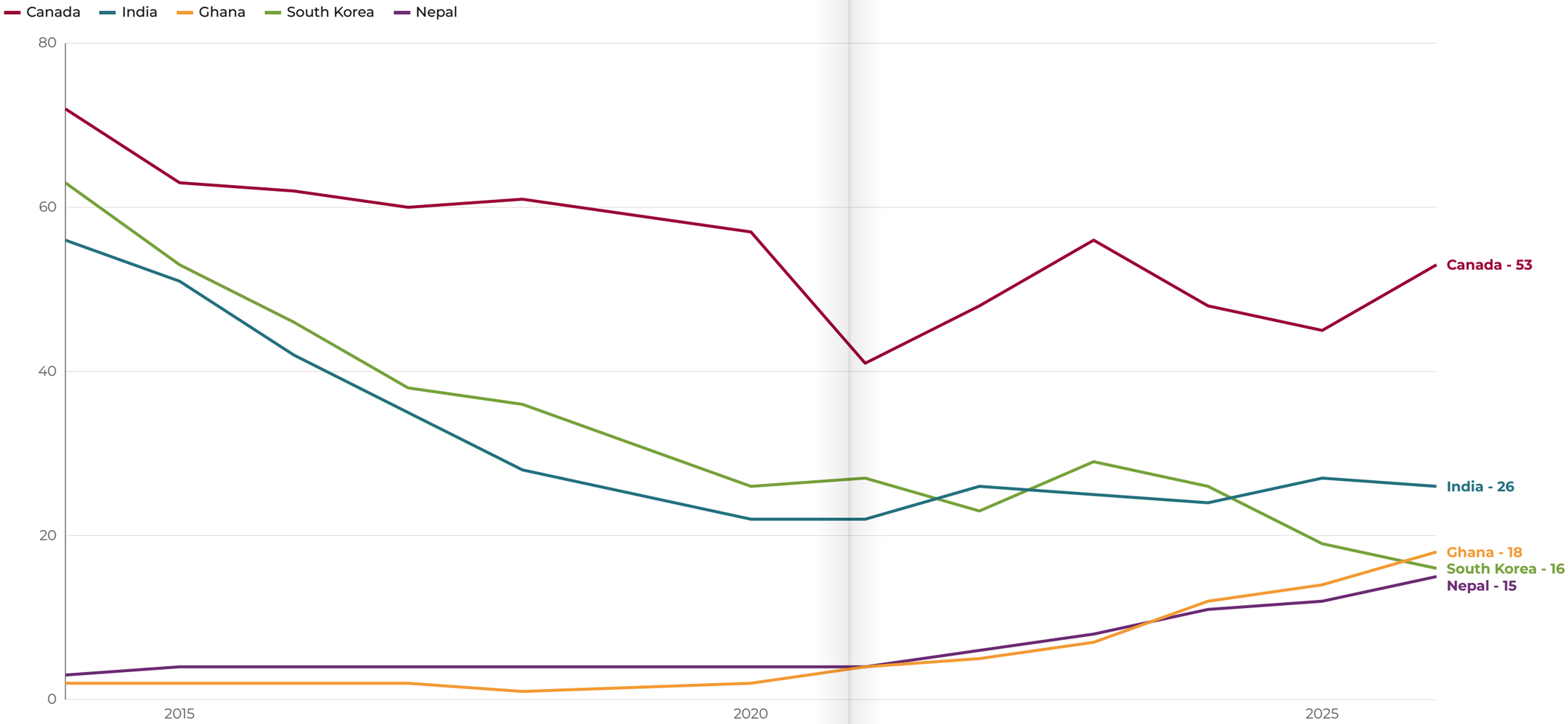
U.S. **22%** · **48th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

16%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **47th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do Alaska's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Alaska had 300 active international students in SEVIS, 51st of 51. Canada accounted for 18% of them and India for 8.7%, against 3.3% and 27% nationally.

Students came from 56 countries, but the two largest supplied 26%. The state's total is down 31% since 2015, when it stood at 433.

300
Active international students, October 2026
51st of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

18%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

66%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

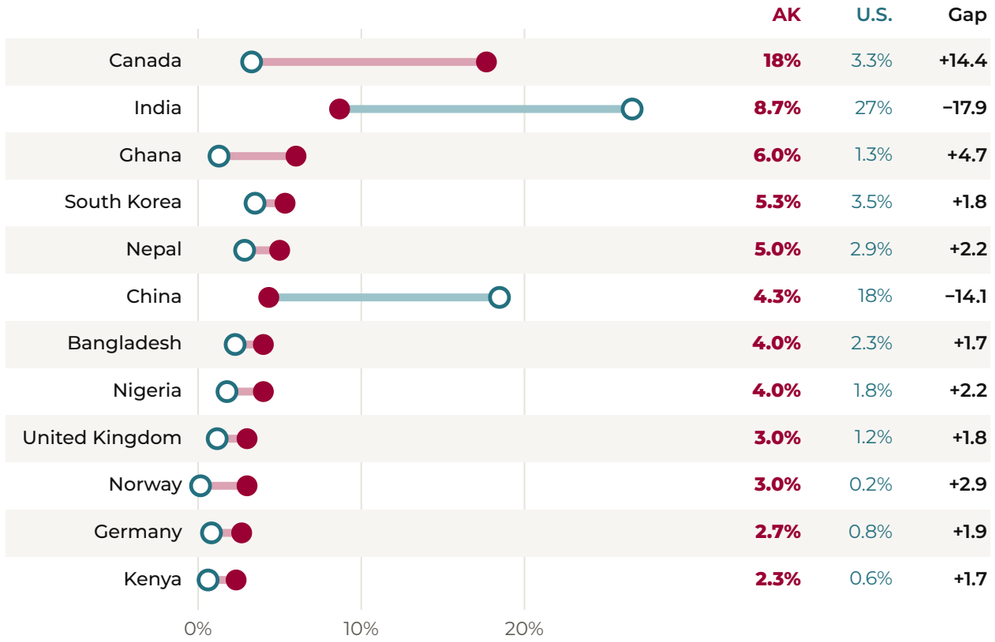
How Does Alaska's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Alaska had **300** active F-1 and M-1 students, 51st among the 50 states and DC and **0.0%** of the U.S. total. They came from 56 countries.

Canada supplied **18%** of them, against 3.3% nationally, and India **8.7%**, against 27%. Ghana (6.0%), South Korea (5.3%), and Nepal (5.0%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **26%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 41st among the states, against 27% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Alaska's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

300
Active international students, October 2026
51st of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

18%
From Canada
U.S. **3.3%**

8.7%
From India
U.S. **27%**

56
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is up 3.4% from 2025 and down 31% since 2015, when it stood at 433. Its share of all U.S. international students is unchanged since 2015, at **0.0%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Canada went from 63 to 53, India's from 51 to 26, and Ghana's from 2 to 18.

Over the same years, the number from South Korea went from 53 to 16 and Nepal's from 4 to 15. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Alaska, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	433	290	**300**	−31%	1.19M	51st
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.0%	0.0%	**0.0%**	0.0 pp	–	51st
Countries of citizenship represented	64	55	**56**	−13%	219	51st
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	25%	**26%**	−0.5 pp	45%	41st
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Canada	63	45	**53**	−16%	3.3%	18%
India	51	27	**26**	−49%	27%	8.7%
Ghana	2	14	**18**	–	1.3%	6.0%
South Korea	53	19	**16**	−70%	3.5%	5.3%
Nepal	4	12	**15**	–	2.9%	5.0%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Alaska's Master's Fields?

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Alaska first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

International share of STEM bachelor's. The share was 2.6% in 2025, against 6.6% for the U.S., 46th among the states, down 0.1 points from 2.7% in 2024 and up 0.6 points since 2015, when it was 2.0%.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	6.4% / 8.6%	**– / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	3.8% / 7.2%	**– / 49%**	– / 55%
Engineering technology	– / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	– / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	– / 6.0%	**– / 33%**	– / 38%
Biological sciences	1.2% / 3.4%	**– / 23%**	– / 23%
Natural resources	0.0% / 2.0%	**– / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	– / 7.3%	**– / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Alaska / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

4.6%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **48th** of 51

16%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **47th** of 51

18%
Int. share of engineering & eng. technology master's, 2020
U.S. **48%** · **45th** of 51

International share of STEM master's. The share was 16% in 2025, against 52% for the U.S., 47th among the states, up 2.1 points from 14% in 2024 and up 1.7 points since 2015, when it was 14%.

International share of STEM research doctorates. The share was 9.1% in 2025, against 43% for the U.S., 51st among the states, down 10.9 points from 20% in 2024 and down 19.5 points since 2015, when it was 29%.

Table 3 Alaska at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
International share of all master's	4.6%	5.9% 2024	**4.6% 2025**	0.0 pp	22%	48th
International share of STEM master's	14%	14% 2024	**16% 2025**	+1.7 pp	52%	47th
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	27%	28% 2019	**18% 2020**	−9.8 pp	48%	45th

Data from NCES, IPEDS.

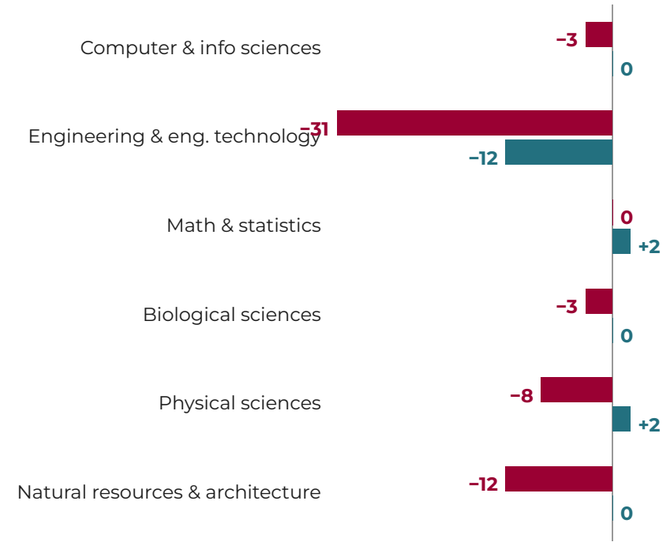
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has Alaska's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Alaska between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 64 in 2025 and 129 in 2015, a change of −8 for international students and −57 for domestic students.

Figure 4 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

10
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **51st** of 51

13%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **45th** of 51

0.0%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
51st of 51

2.9
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **46th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. STEM master's degrees changed by −31 for domestic students and −12 for international students between 2015 and 2025.

Math & statistics. STEM master's degrees changed by +0 for domestic students and +2 for international students between 2015 and 2025.

International students' STEM master's degrees. The number was 10 in 2025, against 117K for the U.S., 51st among the states, down from 13 in 2024 and down since 2015, when it was 18.

Table 4 Alaska at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
International STEM master's	18	13 2024	**10 2025**	–	117K	51st
STEM share of master's	18%	21% 2024	**13% 2025**	−5.1 pp	23%	45th
Share of U.S. international STEM master's	0.0%	0.0% 2024	**0.0% 2025**	0.0 pp	–	51st
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate	4.6	3.8 2024	**2.9 2025**	−1.7	6.4	46th

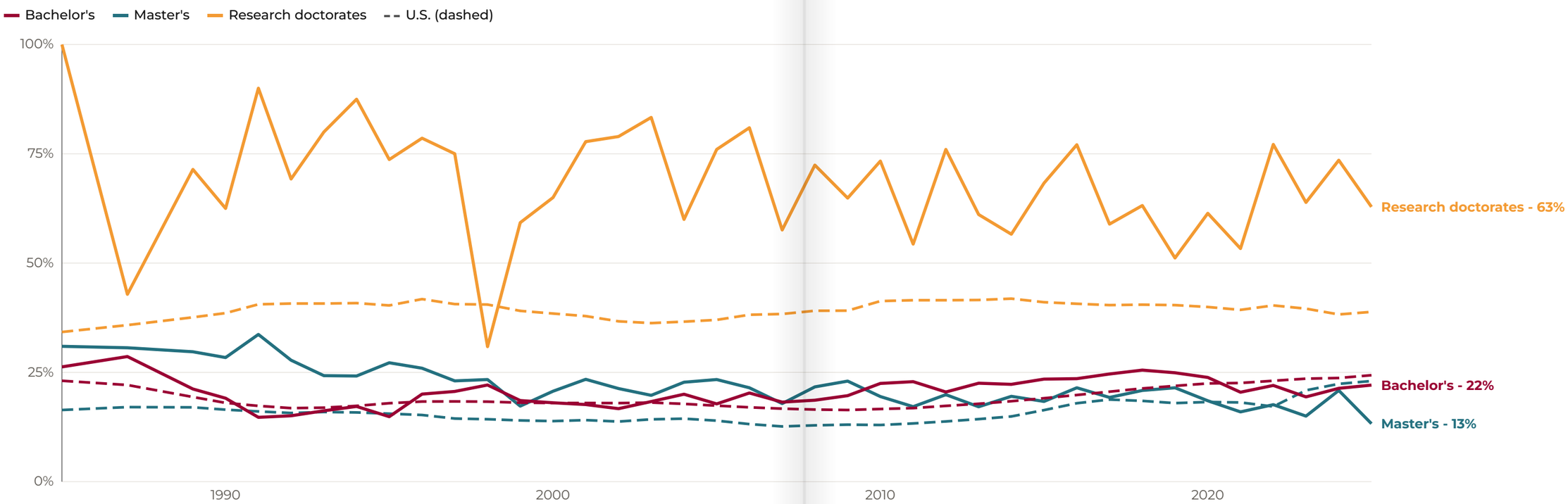
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Alaska ranks 2nd of 51 on the STEM share of research doctorates, at 63% in 2025 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 5 How Much of Alaska's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 22% of Alaska's bachelor's degrees, 13% of its master's and 63% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is down 5.1 points since 2015, and the state ranks 45th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 31st of 51.

22%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **31st** of 51 · −1.4 pp since 2015

13%

STEM share of master's, 2025

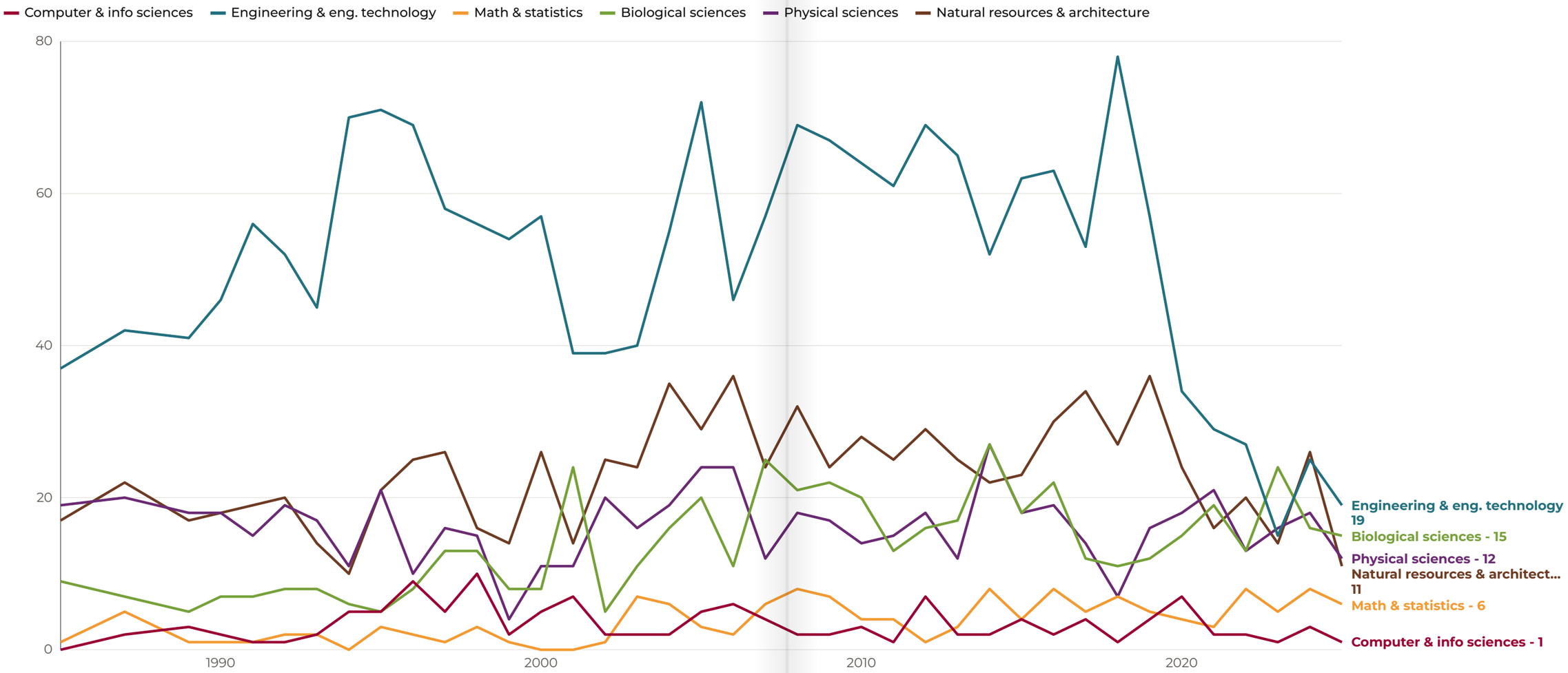
U.S. **23%** · **45th** of 51 · −5.1 pp since 2015

63%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **2nd** of 51 · −5.4 pp since 2015

Figure 6 Which STEM Fields Produce Alaska's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Engineering & eng. technology produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 19, followed by biological sciences (15) and physical sciences (12). Master's degrees in engineering & eng. technology are down 69% since 2015.

International students earned 10 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.0% of the national total (51st of 51).

10

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **51st** of 51

0.0%

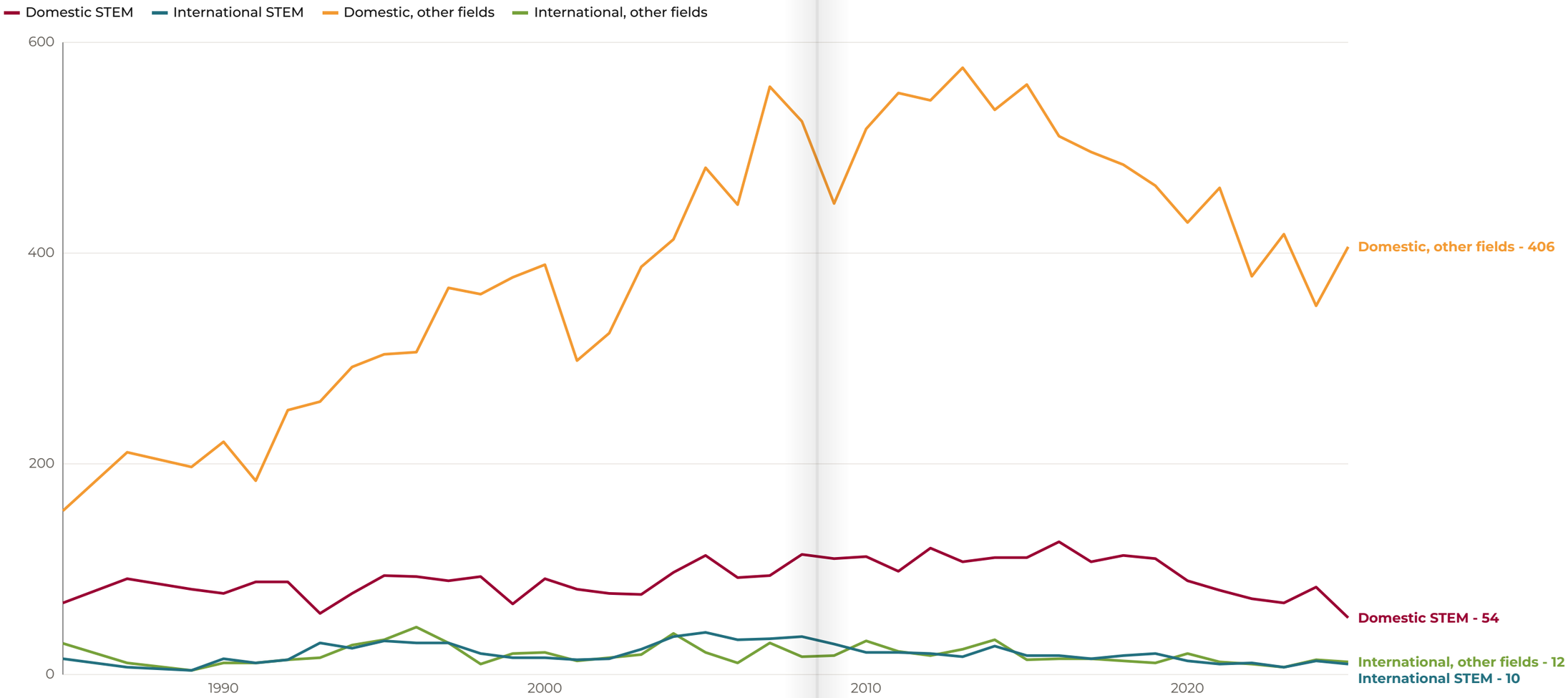
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

51st of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

–

Int. share of CS master's, null

Figure 7 Who Earns Alaska's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, −8 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and −57 more to domestic students.

International students earn 16% of Alaska's STEM master's but 2.9% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

4.6%

Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **48th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

16%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **47th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

2.9

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **46th** of 51 · −1.7 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Alaska ranks 50th of 51 on net student migration, at −27 in 2024.

Figure 8 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations (more when states tie at the printed figure), the rest grouped; ties are ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

2.39K residents stayed in Alaska for college in fall 2024; 668 students arrived from other states and 33 from abroad, while 1.8K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 77% of the state's first-time students are residents.

77%

First-time students from in state, 2024

14th of 51 · −14.9 pp since 2016

1.1%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

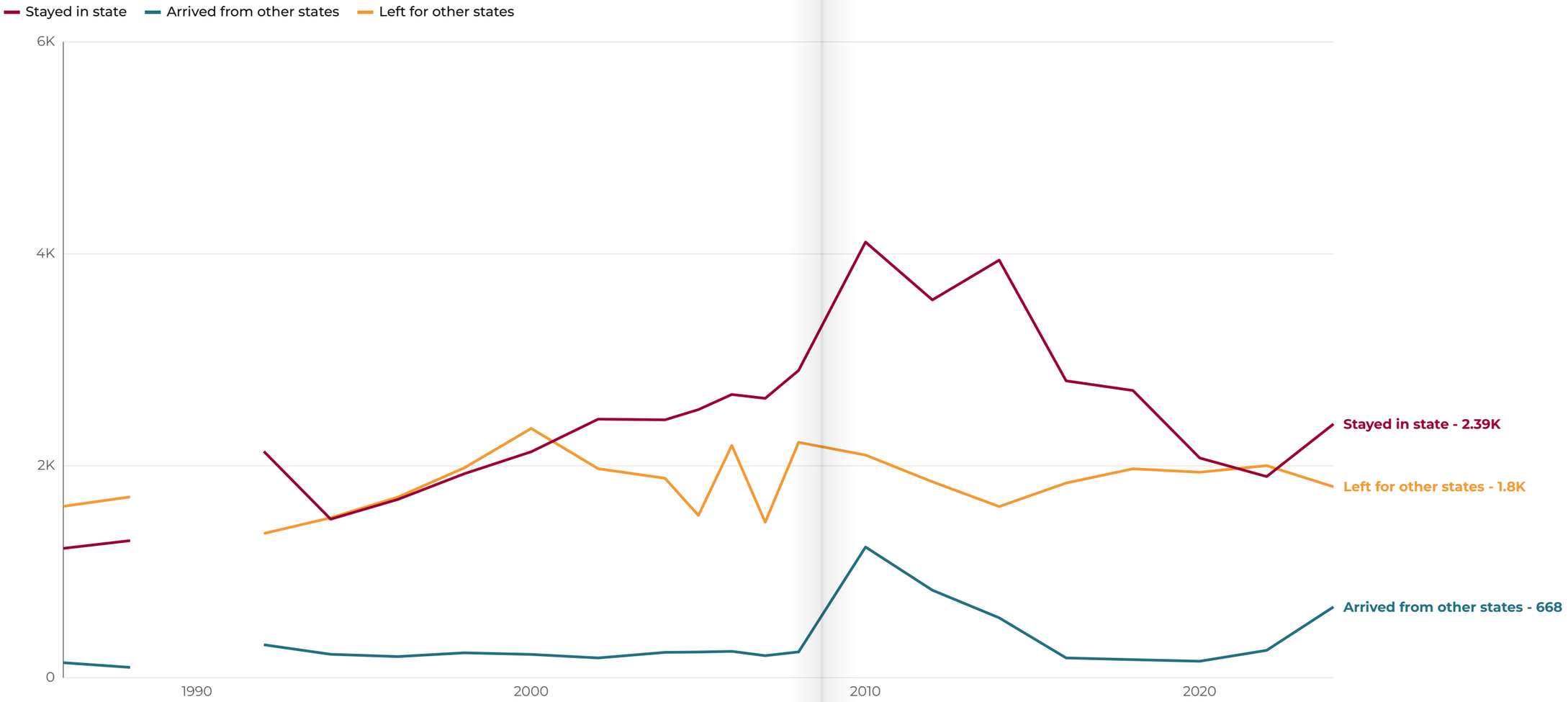
U.S. **3.1%** · **47th** of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2016

−27

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

50th of 51 · +8.5 since 2016

Figure 9 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 15%, arrivals from other states are up 257%, and residents leaving are roughly flat.

Net migration was −27 per 100 resident first-time students (50th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Arizona (217).

Figure 10

Where Do Alaska's Newcomers Come From?

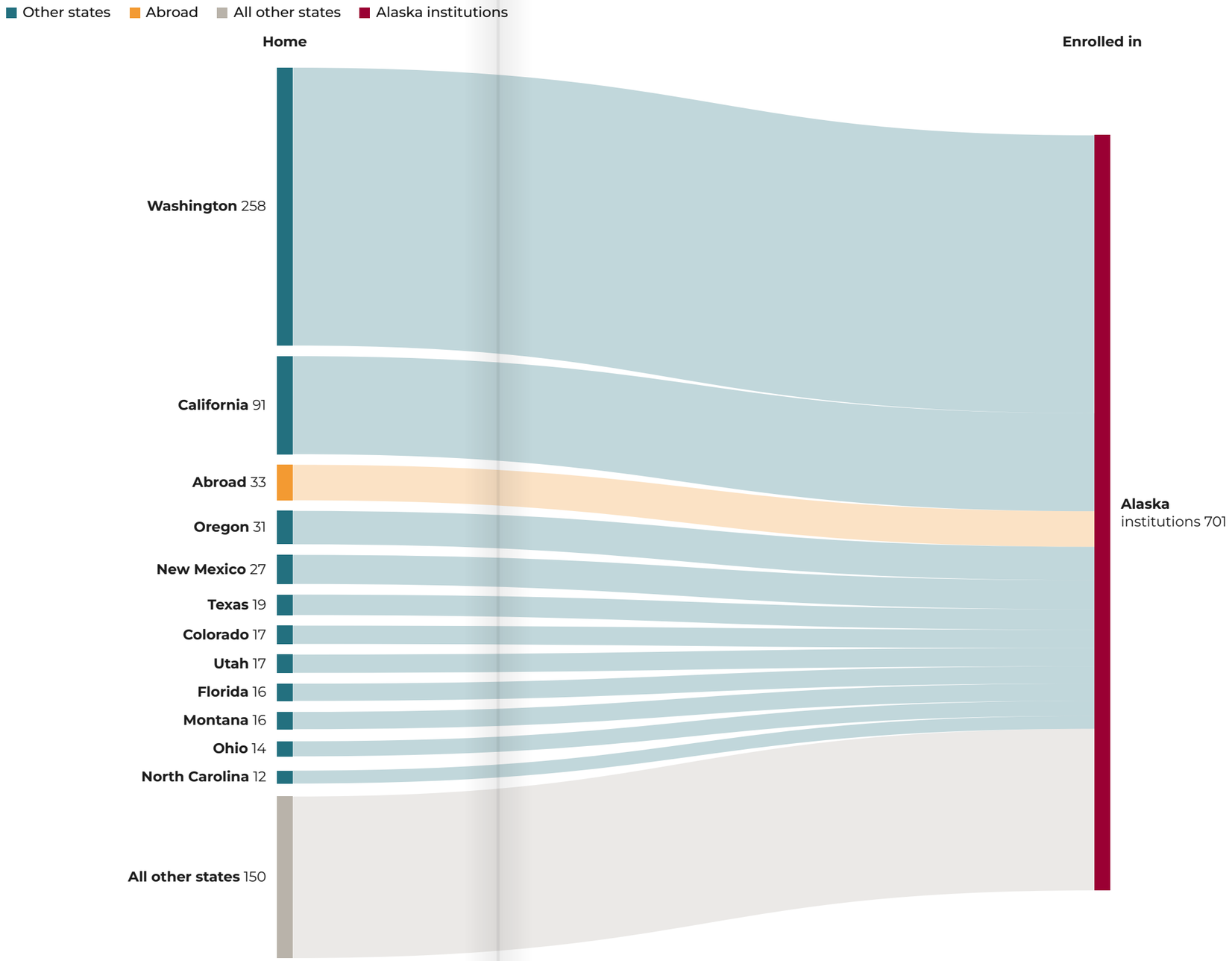
The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Alaska's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

Students arriving from other states. The number was 668 in fall 2024, up 158% from 259 in fall 2022 and up 257% since fall 2016, when it was 187.

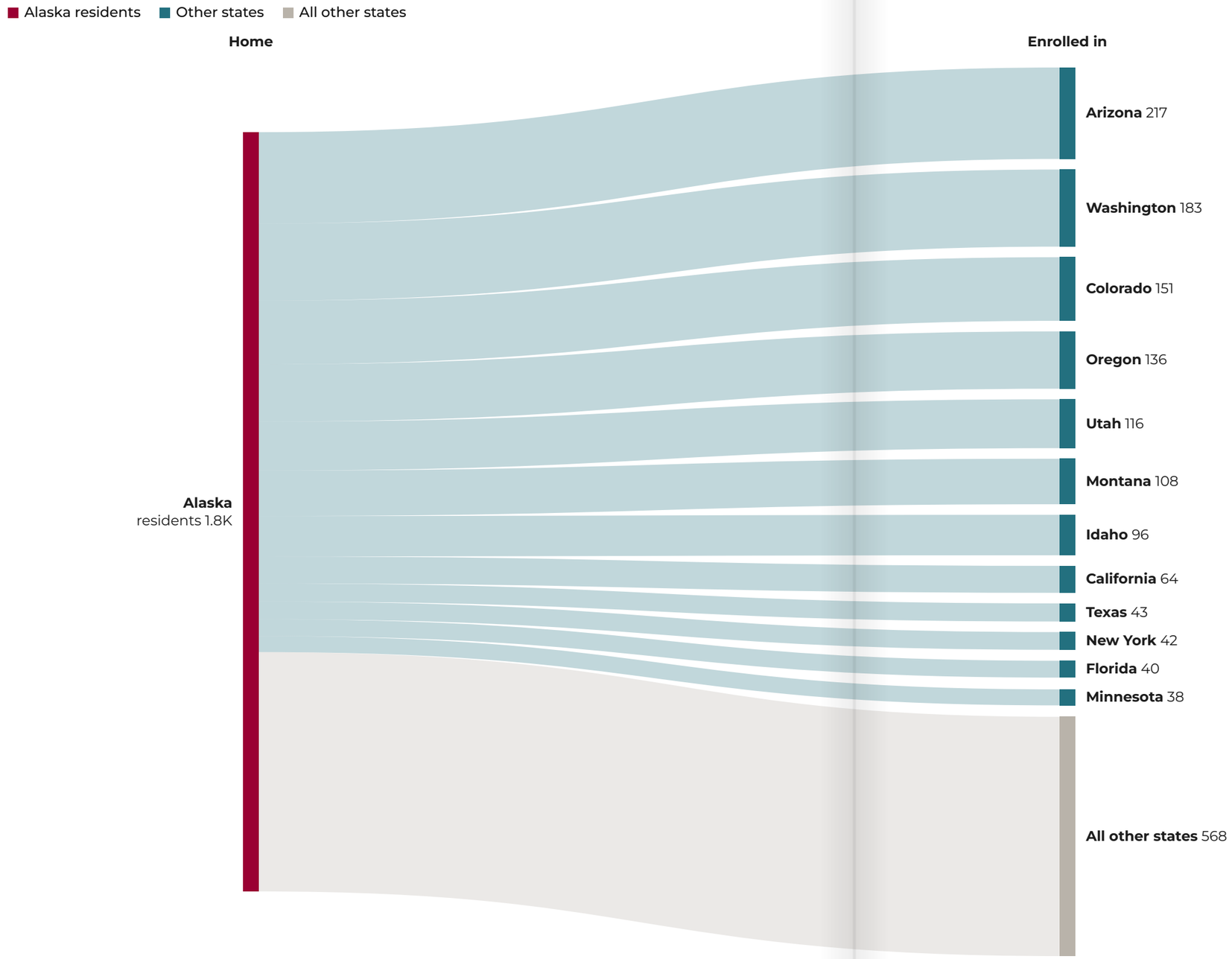
701
First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024
Abroad **33**

1.1%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **47th** of 51 · −0.6 pp since 2016

77%
First-time students from in state, 2024
14th of 51 · −14.9 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows (more when states tie at the printed figure), ordered by exact count. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 11

Where Do Alaska's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Alaska residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 1.8K in fall 2024, down 9.9% from 2K in fall 2022 and down 1.9% since fall 2016, when it was 1.84K.

1.8K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrived from other states **668** · **701** with abroad

−27
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
50th of 51 · +8.5 since 2016

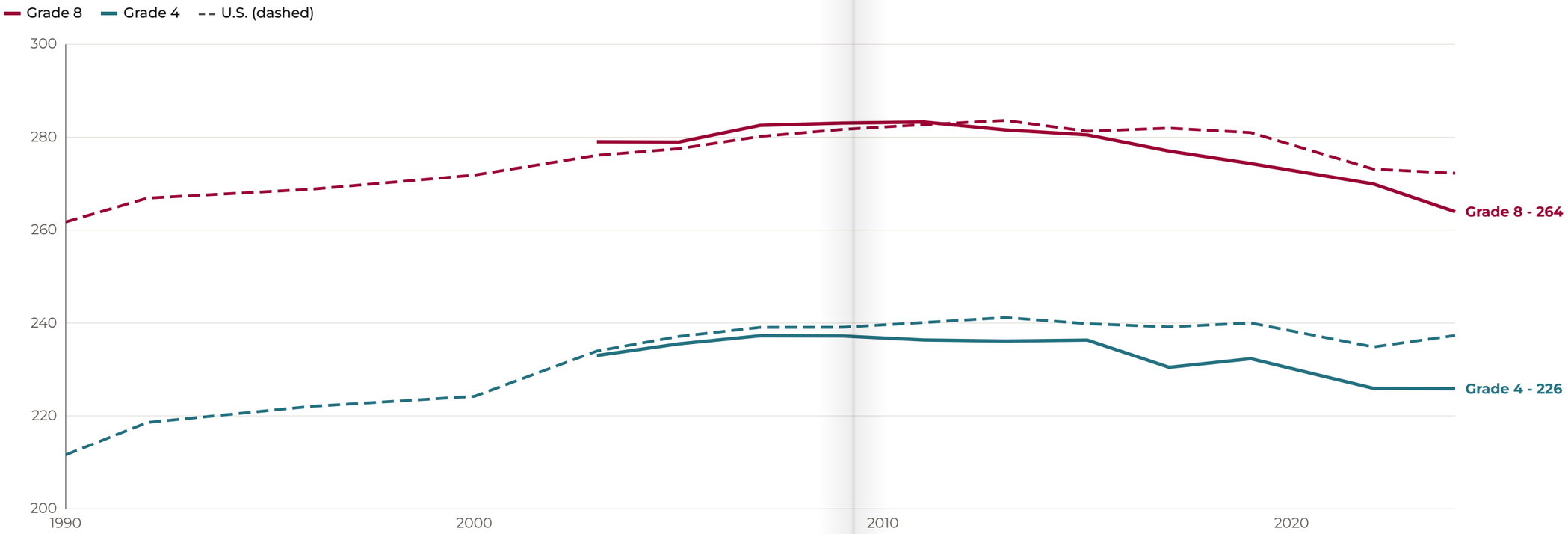
217
Went to Arizona
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Alaska ranks 50th of 51 on the average grade 8 reading score, at 246 in 2024 against 257 for the U.S.

Figure 12 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Alaska's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Alaska's eighth graders averaged 264 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 46th of 51 among the states.

22% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

264

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **46th** of 51 · −16.5 since 2015

22%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **41st** of 51 · −10.3 pp since 2015

246

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

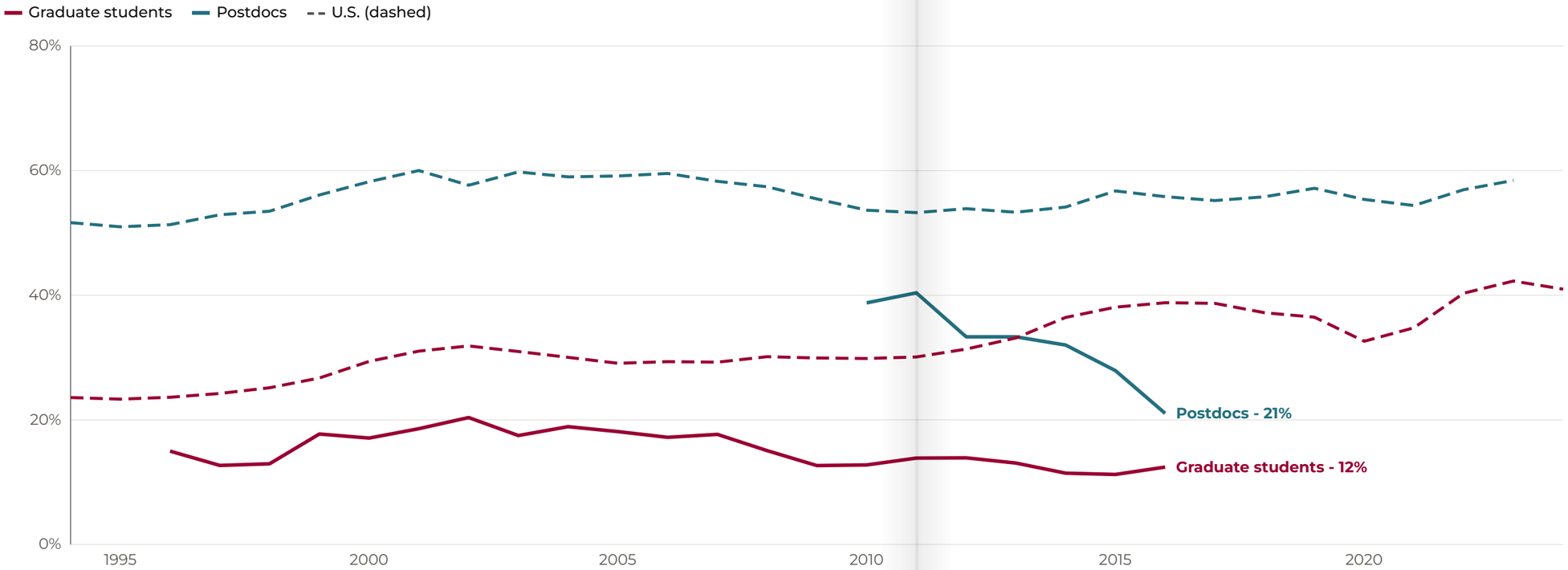
U.S. **257** · **50th** of 51 · −13.9 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Alaska ranks 51st of 51 on the temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs, at 21% in 2016 against 56% for the U.S.

Figure 13 How Many of Alaska's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 12% of Alaska's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 50th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 21% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 35 research doctorates in 2025, 0.1% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

12%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **50th** of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2015

21%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **51st** of 51 · −6.9 pp since 2015

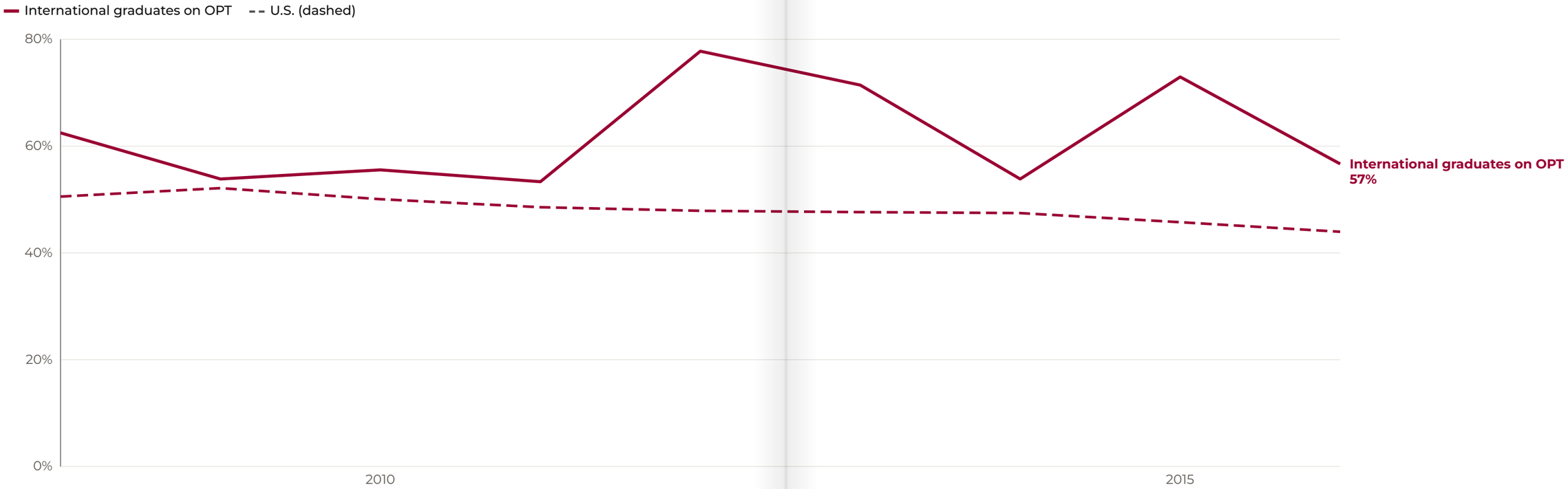
35
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **51st** of 51

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Alaska ranks 4th of 51 on net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents, at +13.4 in 2025.

Figure 14 How Many of Alaska's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Alaska's institutions do not take part in the Census Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes program, so in-state employment of its graduates is not published.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 57% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state gained 13.4 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

57%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **6th** of 51 · −16.3 pp since 2015

+13.4

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

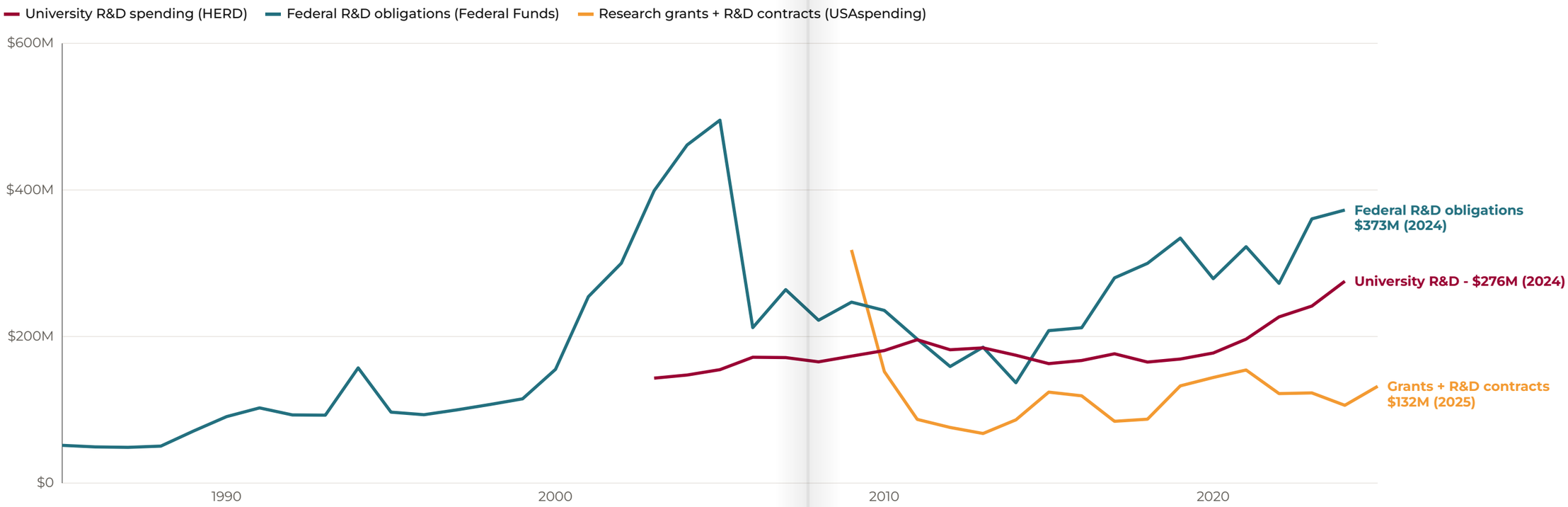
4th of 51 · +21.7 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Alaska ranks 4th of 51 on the federally funded share of university R&D, at 67% in 2024 against 55% for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Much Research Money Flows Into Alaska?



Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Alaska's universities spent $276M on research and development in FY2024, 46th of 51 among the states; 67% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $373M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$276M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **46th** of 51 · +69% since 2015

67%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **4th** of 51 · +10.8 pp since 2015

$373M

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

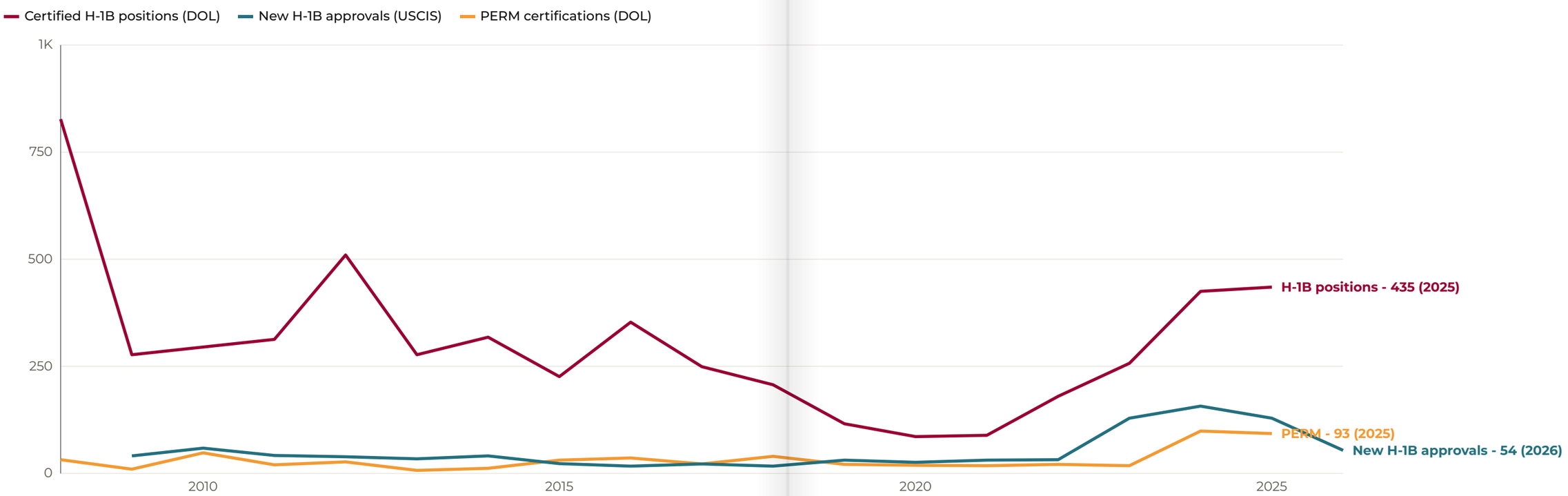
U.S. **$193B** · **41st** of 51 · +79% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Alaska ranks 48th of 51 on certified H-1B positions, by worksite, at 435 in 2025 against 914K for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Alaska Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 435 H-1B positions at Alaska worksites in FY2025, 48th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 54 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 160 continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 93 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 16% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

435

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **48th** of 51 · +92% since 2015

93

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

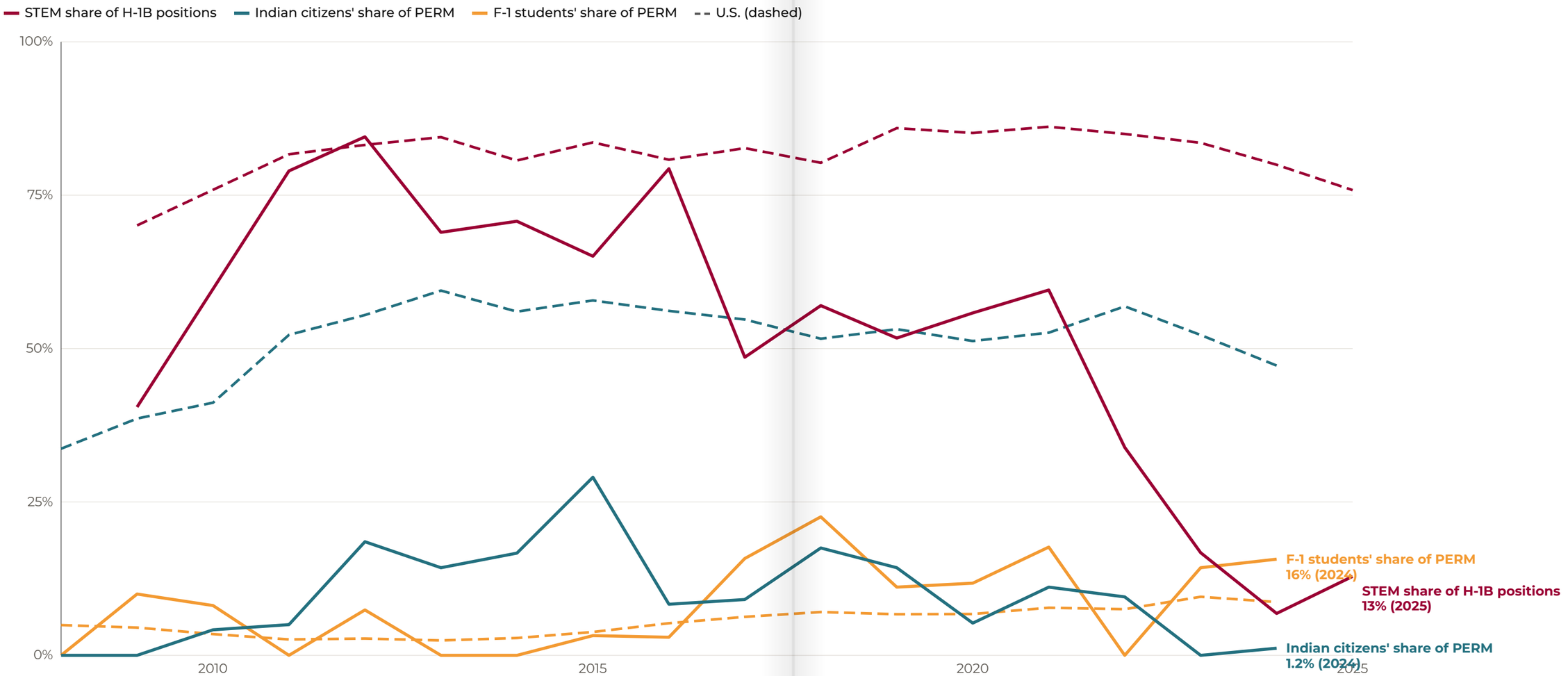
U.S. **138K** · **47th** of 51

16%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **8th** of 51 · +12.5 pp since 2015

Figure 17 Who Holds Alaska's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

13% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 1.2% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

13%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **51st** of 51 · −52.2 pp since 2015

1.2%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **51st** of 51 · −27.9 pp since 2015

$71.9K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

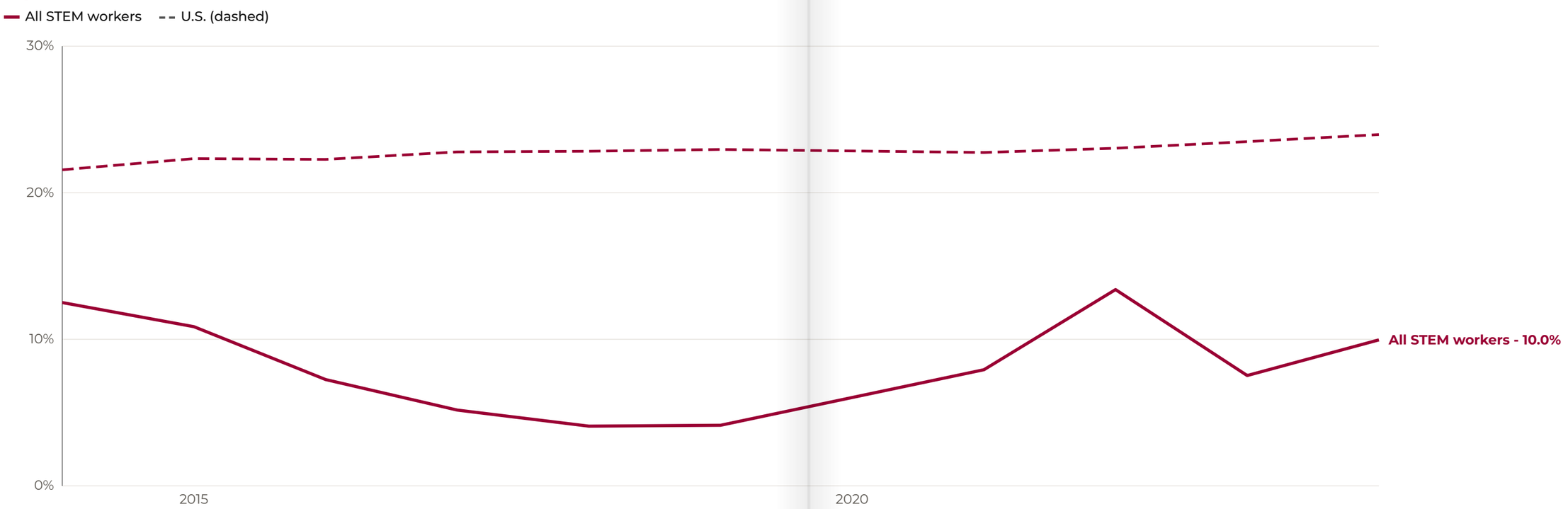
U.S. **$119K** · **49th** of 51 · +2.7% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Alaska ranks 38th of 51 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers, at 10.0% in 2024 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Much of Alaska's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 10.0% of the people working in STEM occupations in Alaska were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 38th of 51).

10.0%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **38th** of 51 · −0.9 pp since 2015

6.4%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

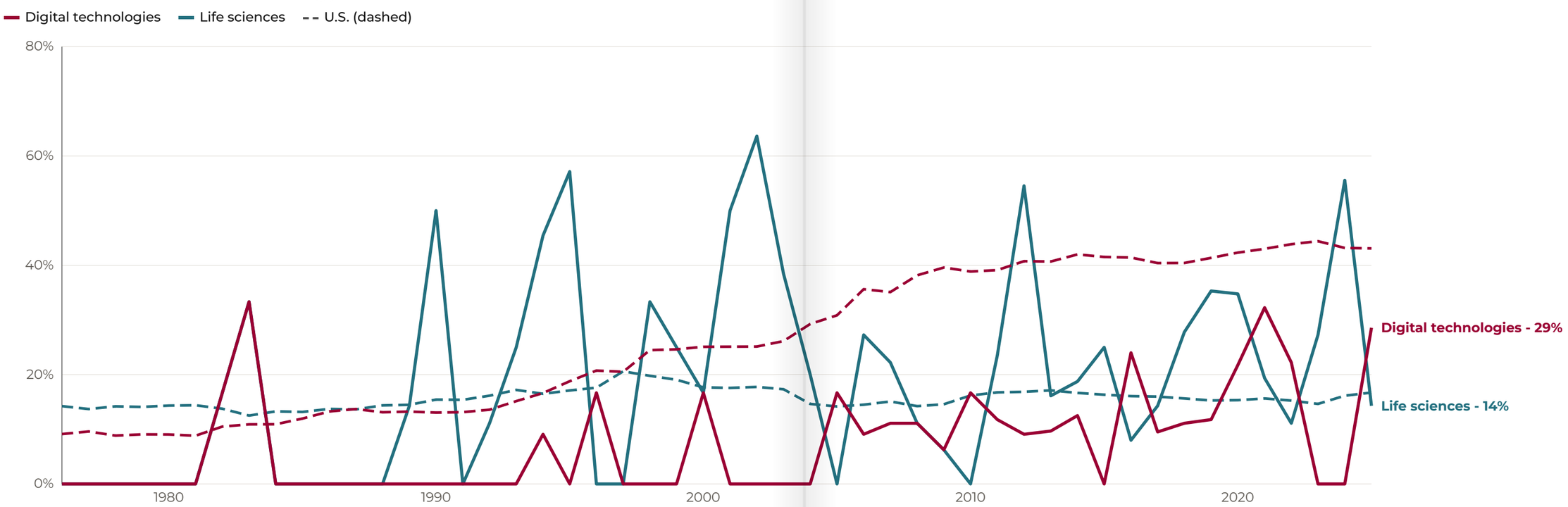
U.S. **11%** · **27th** of 51 · +0.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Alaska ranks 51st of 51 on patents granted to assignees in the state, at 7 in 2025 against 135K for the U.S.

Figure 19 What Kinds of Technology Does Alaska Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Alaska were granted 7 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.0% of all patents with a U.S. owner (51st of 51).

29% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 14% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

7

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **51st** of 51

29%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **16th** of 51 · +28.6 pp since 2015

14%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

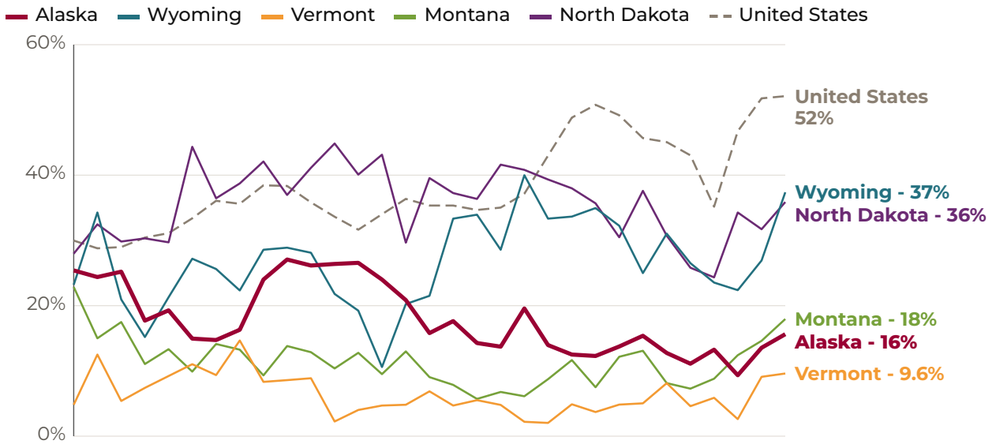
U.S. **17%** · **31st** of 51 · −10.7 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are Wyoming, Vermont, Montana, and North Dakota. Alaska ranks 4th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Wyoming is the most dependent at 37%.

Figure 20 How Dependent Are Alaska and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



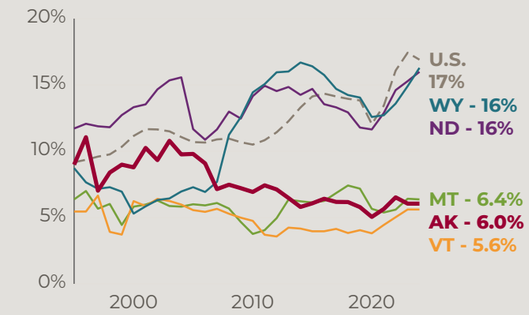
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 5 How Does Alaska Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	AK	WY	VT	MT	ND	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**22.7K**	31.1K	38.3K	48.4K	53.5K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**9.0%**	8.6%	15%	12%	15%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**22%**	22%	34%	32%	21%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**13%**	17%	13%	22%	18%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**10**	37	20	56	122	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.0%**	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.1%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**16%**	37%	9.6%	18%	36%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**9.1%**	37%	20%	12%	57%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**6.0%**	16%	5.6%	6.4%	16%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**1.2%**	1.7%	3.0%	1.1%	2.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**31%**	59%	70%	52%	60%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$8.04K**	$5.82K	$17.5K	$7.93K	$9.87K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$28K**	$21.3K	$5.33K	$9.29K	$11.9K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$90K**	$85.4K	$94K	$82K	$82.6K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**77%**	65%	29%	58%	50%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**−27**	+6	+55	+21	+42	–

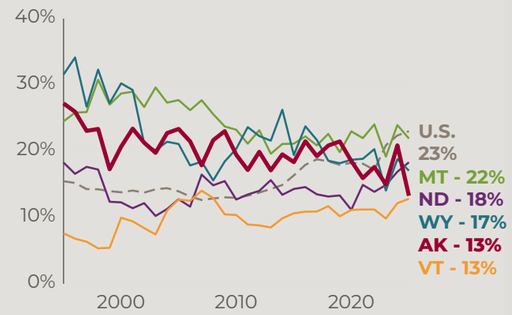
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 21 Int. share of grad students



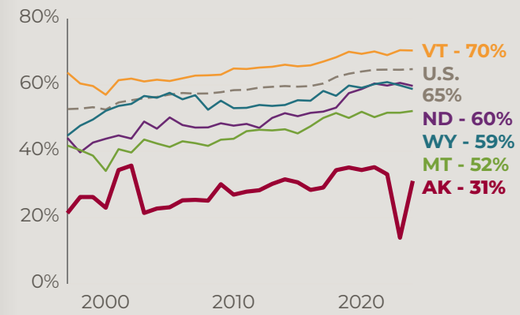
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 22 STEM share of master's



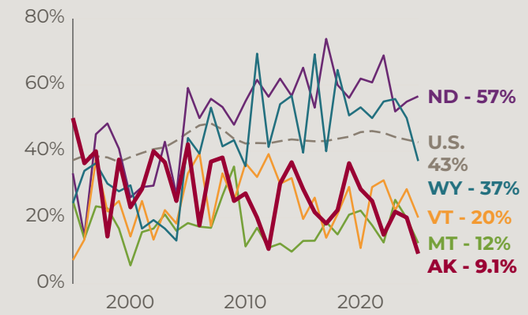
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 Int. share of STEM doctorates

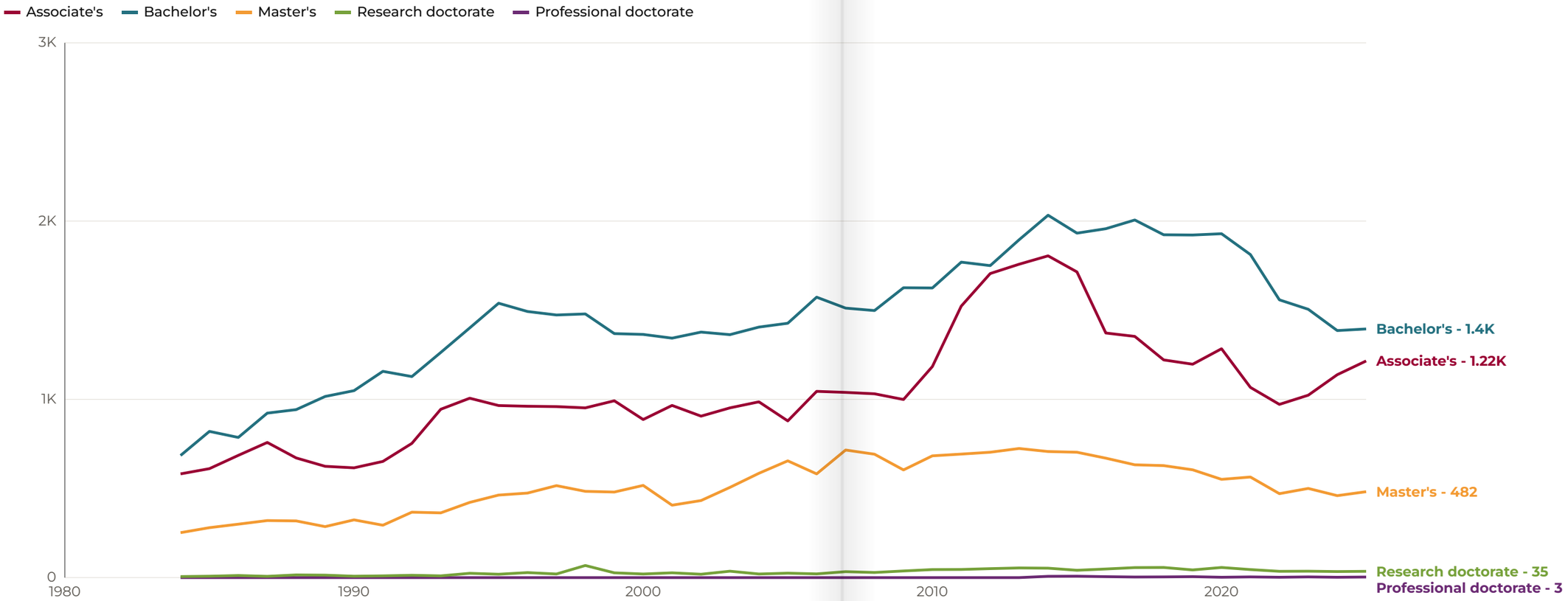


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 25 How Many Degrees Does Alaska Award?

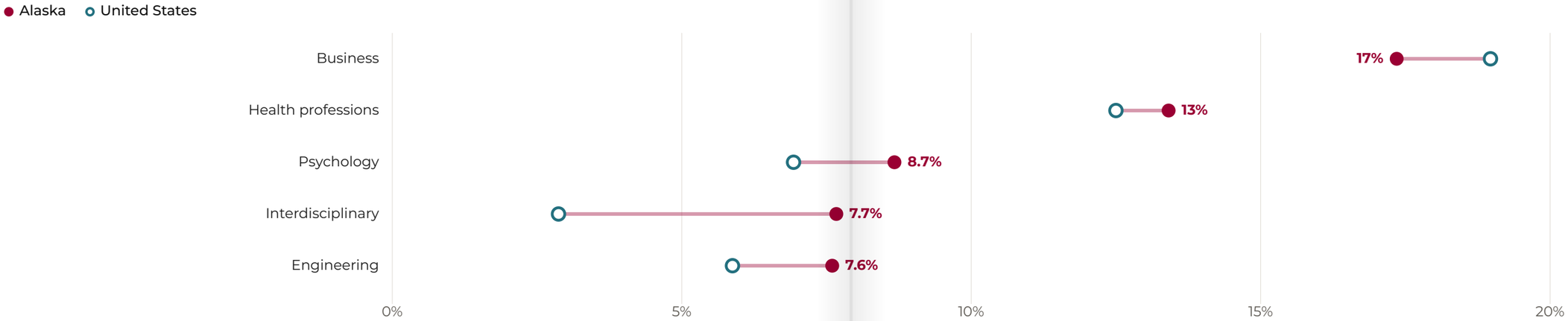


Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Alaska's institutions awarded 1.22K associate's degrees, 1.4K bachelor's degrees, 482 master's degrees, 35 research doctorate degrees, 3 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 29%; bachelor's down 28%; master's down 31%; research doctorate down 15%; professional doctorate down 63%. The state awards 6.7 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 26 What Do Alaska's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Alaska's largest bachelor's fields are business (17%; U.S. 19%), health professions (13%; U.S. 13%), psychology (8.7%; U.S. 6.9%).

Relative to the nation, Alaska's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in interdisciplinary (2.67× the U.S. share), engineering (1.29× the U.S. share), psychology (1.25× the U.S. share).

3.4%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **46th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

8.5%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

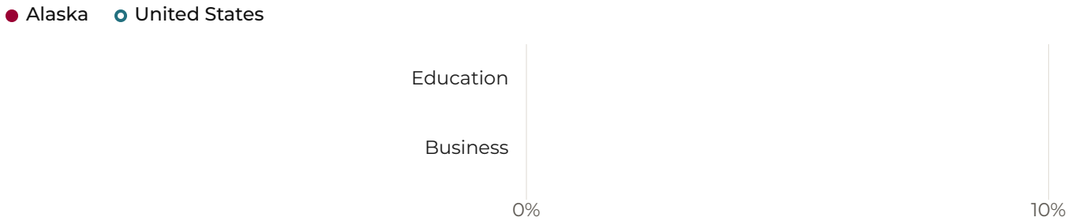
U.S. **6.8%** · **10th** of 51 · −1.1 pp since 2015

17%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **37th** of 51 · −1.1 pp since 2015

Figure 27 What Do Alaska's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Alaska's largest master's fields are education (28%; U.S. 15%), business (21%; U.S. 21%).

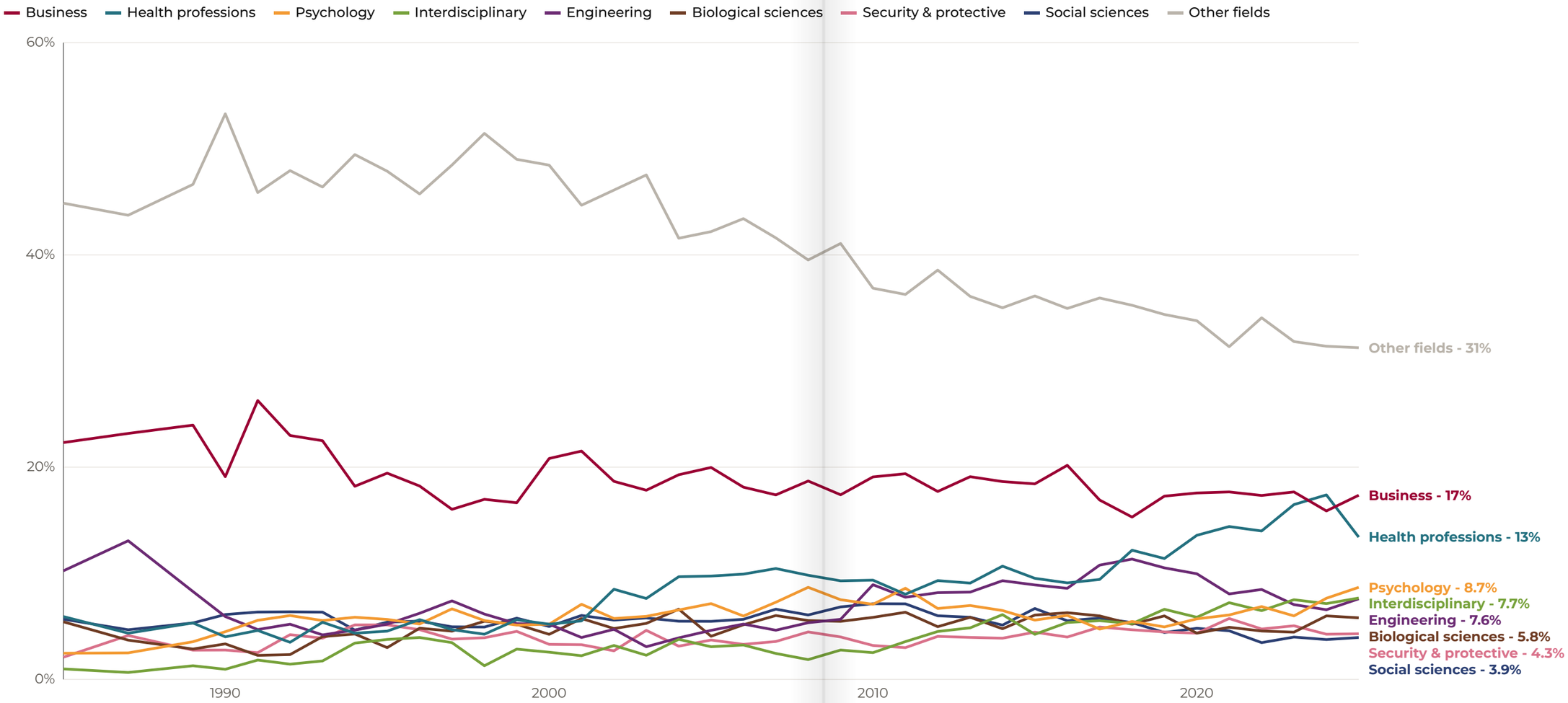
International students earn 4.6% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 13% of them.

13%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **45th** of 51 · −5.1 pp since 2015

4.6%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **48th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

–
Int. share of CS master's, null

Figure 28 How Has Alaska's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, health professions has gained the most ground, 3.9 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while social sciences lost the most (2.7 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Alaska Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Alaska's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 5 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Interdisciplinary (2.67, with 7.7% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 2.9% for the U.S.), engineering (1.29, with 7.6% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 5.9% for the U.S.), and psychology (1.25, with 8.7% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 6.9% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 6 Where Is Alaska Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Interdisciplinary	**2.67**	7.7%	2.9%	107
Engineering	**1.29**	7.6%	5.9%	106
Psychology	**1.25**	8.7%	6.9%	121
Health professions	**1.07**	13%	13%	187
Business	**0.91**	17%	19%	242

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

22%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **31st** of 51

3.4%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **46th** of 51

8.5%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **10th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 8.5% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 10th among the states, up 1.5 points from 7.1% in 2024 and down 1.1 points since 2015, when it was 9.7%.

Health professions. The share was 13% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 16th among the states, down 4.0 points from 17% in 2024 and up 3.9 points since 2015, when it was 9.5%.

Table 7 Alaska at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	23%	21% 2024	**22% 2025**	−1.4 pp	24%	31st
Bachelor's in computer science	1.7%	3.2% 2024	**3.4% 2025**	+1.7 pp	6.9%	46th
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	9.7%	7.1% 2024	**8.5% 2025**	−1.1 pp	6.8%	10th
Bachelor's in business	18%	16% 2024	**17% 2025**	−1.1 pp	19%	37th

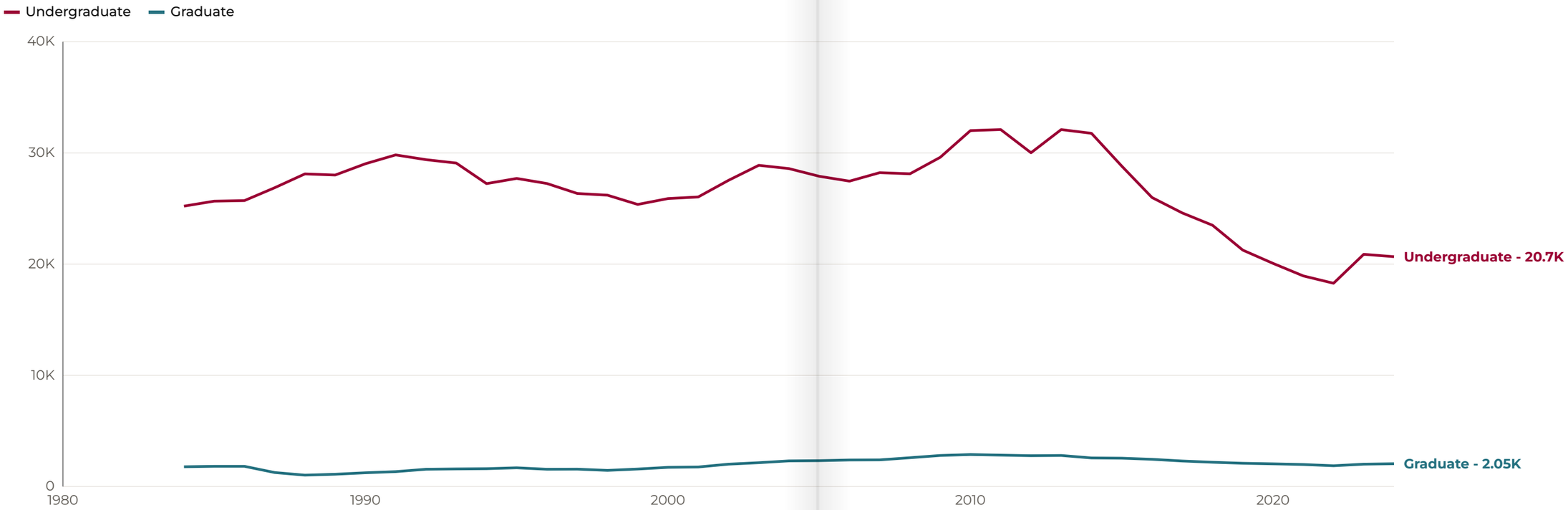
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Alaska ranks 51st of 51 on fall enrollment, at 22.7K in 2024 against 19.7M for the U.S.

Figure 29 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Alaska enrolled 20.7K undergraduates and 2.05K graduate students, 22.7K in all (51st of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 28% since 2015 and graduate enrollment down 20% since 2015. Graduate students are 9.0% of all students (U.S. 17%).

22.7K
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · **51st** of 51 · −28% since 2015

9.0%
Graduate share of students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · **49th** of 51 · +0.9 pp since 2015

52%
Students attending part-time, 2024
U.S. **39%** · **3rd** of 51 · +0.1 pp since 2015

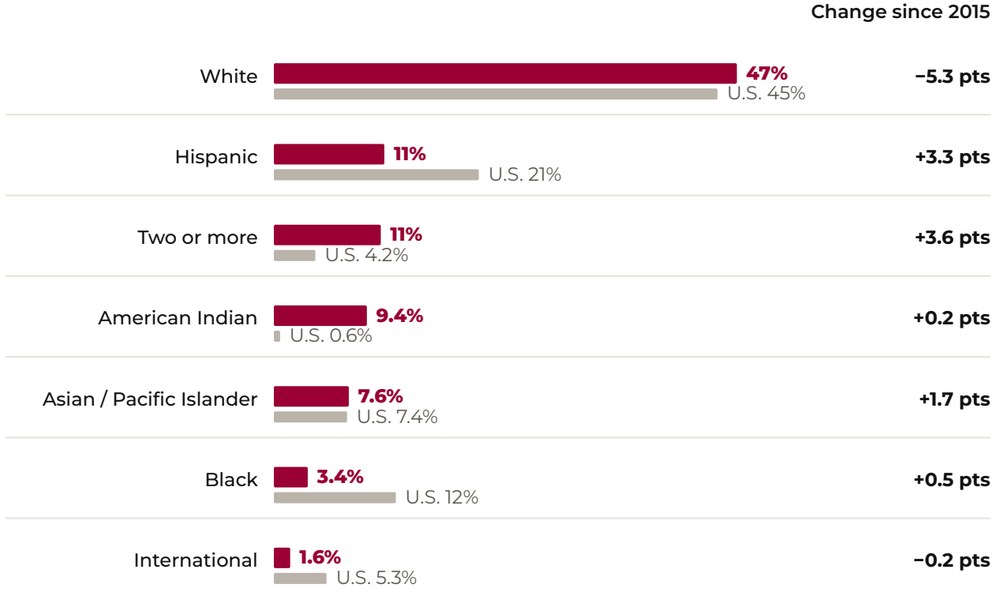
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in Alaska, and Where?

In fall 2024, White students were the largest group at Alaska's degree-granting institutions, **47%** of enrollment against 45% nationally, down 5.3 points since 2015.

Hispanic students were **11%** (U.S. 21%), up 3.3 points since 2015, and students of two or more races were **11%** (U.S. 4.2%), up 3.6 points since 2015.

Figure 30 Who Enrolls in Alaska?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

47%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −5.3 pp since 2015

11%
Hispanic students
U.S. **21%** · +3.3 pp since 2015

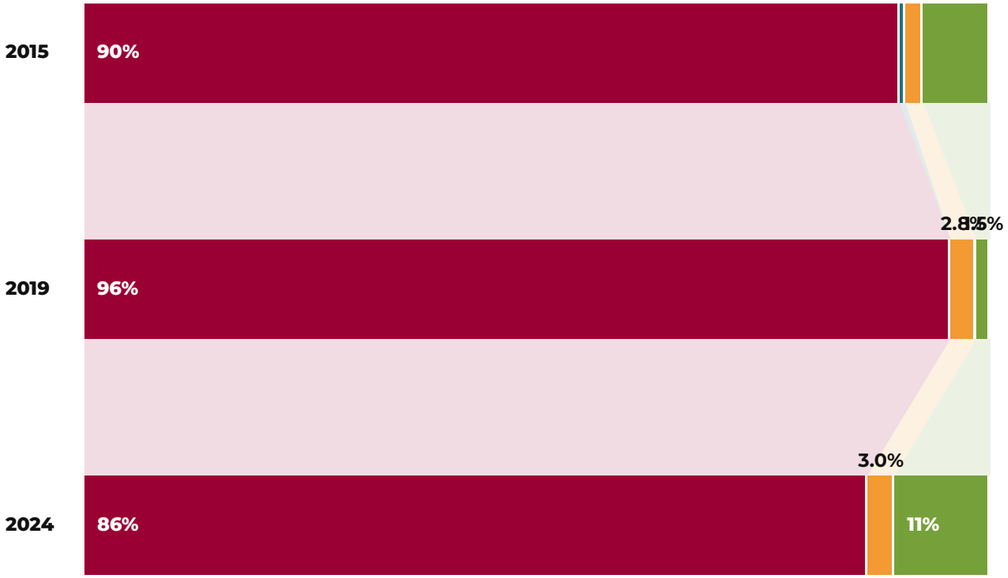
86%
At public 4-year institutions
−3.6 pp since 2015

11%
At for-profit institutions
+3.2 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **86%** of students, down 3.6 points from 90% in 2015. For-profit institutions enrolled **11%** of students, up 3.2 points from 7.4% in 2015.

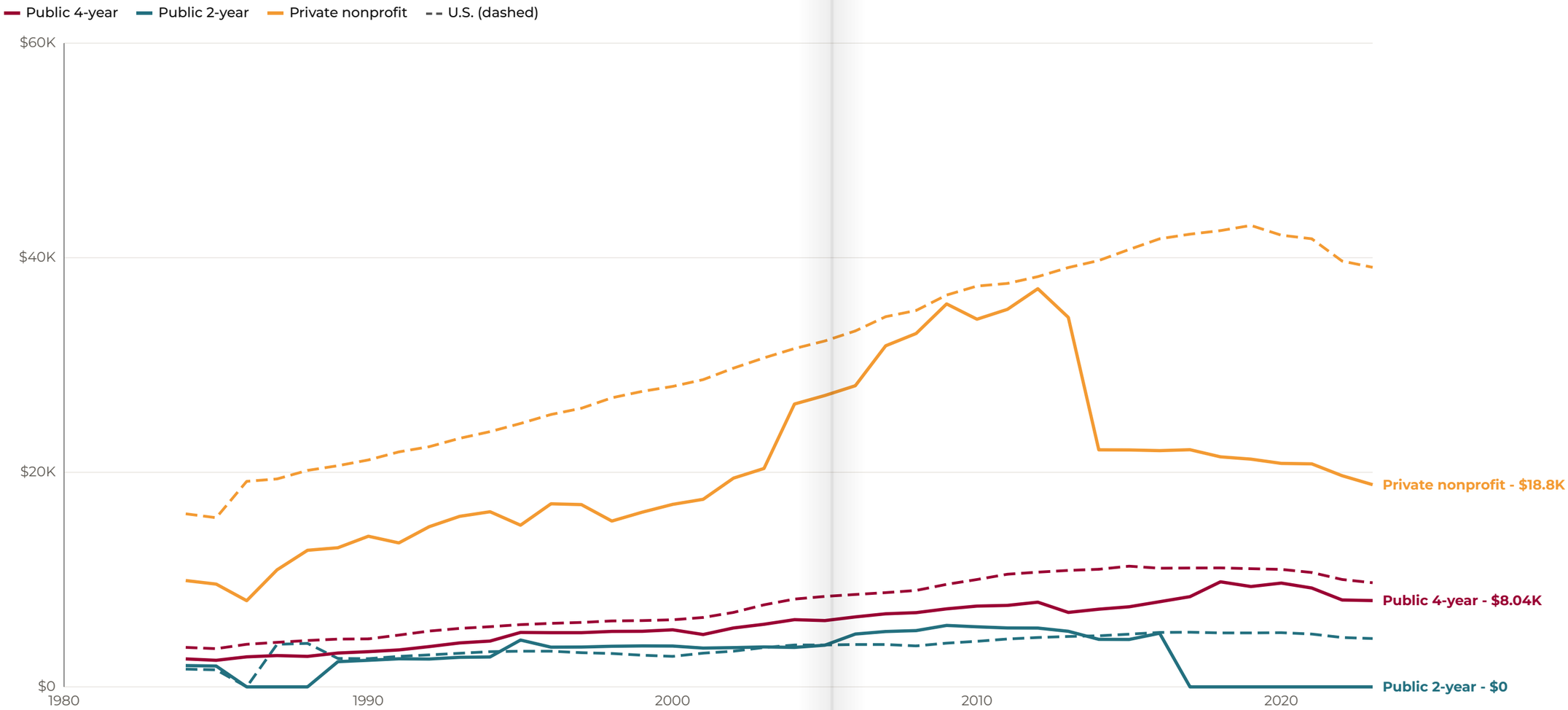
Part of the shift between public sectors is a change of label: one community college that IPEDS counted as public 2-year in 2015 is counted as public 4-year in 2024 because it began awarding bachelor's degrees. It enrolled **256** students, 1.1% of the state's total, the largest being Ilisagvik College.

Figure 31 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year; 1 former public 2-year colleges (1.1% of 2024 enrollment) count as public 4-year after they began awarding bachelor's degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 32 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Alaska's public four-year institutions are $8.04K (2023, 2024 dollars), 17% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 41st of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $28K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (2nd of 51), and net tuition makes up 24% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).

$8.04K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **41st** of 51 · +7.7% since 2015

$28K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **2nd** of 51 · +5.1% since 2015

24%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **48th** of 51 · −0.9 pp since 2015

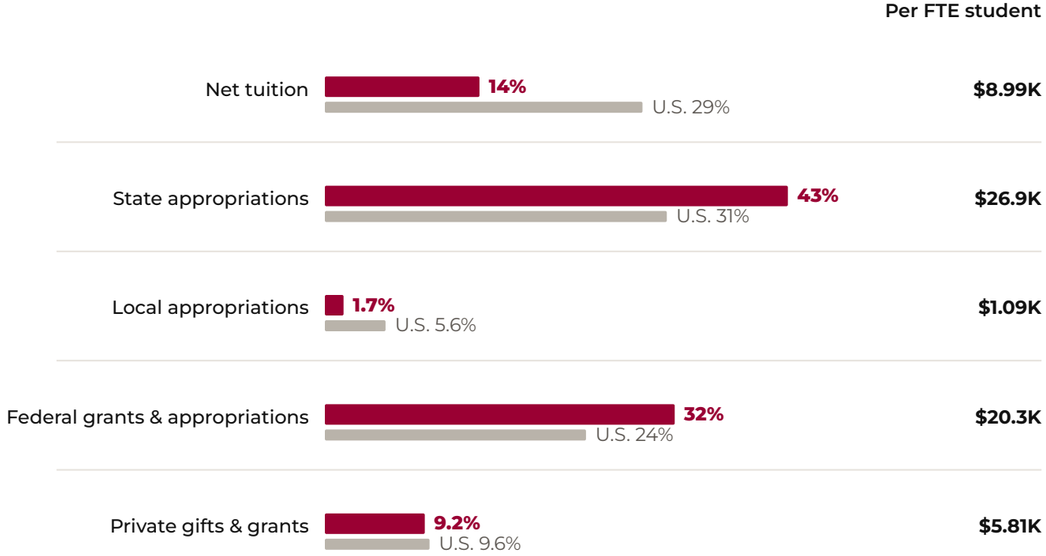
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Alaska's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Alaska's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $8.99K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 4.7% from $9.44K in FY2023 and down 3.0% since FY2015, when it was $9.27K.

Figure 33 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$8.04K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **41st** of 51

$28K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **2nd** of 51

24%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **48th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Alaska: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $8.04K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 41st among the states, down 0.7% from $8.1K in 2022 and up 7.7% since 2015, when it was $7.46K.

Table 8 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Alaska	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$8.04K**	$9.71K	41st of 51	+7.7%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$28K**	$11.4K	2nd of 51	+5.1%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**24%**	43%	48th of 51	−0.9 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**31%**	65%	51st of 51	+0.4 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$90K**	$106K	34th of 51	−16%

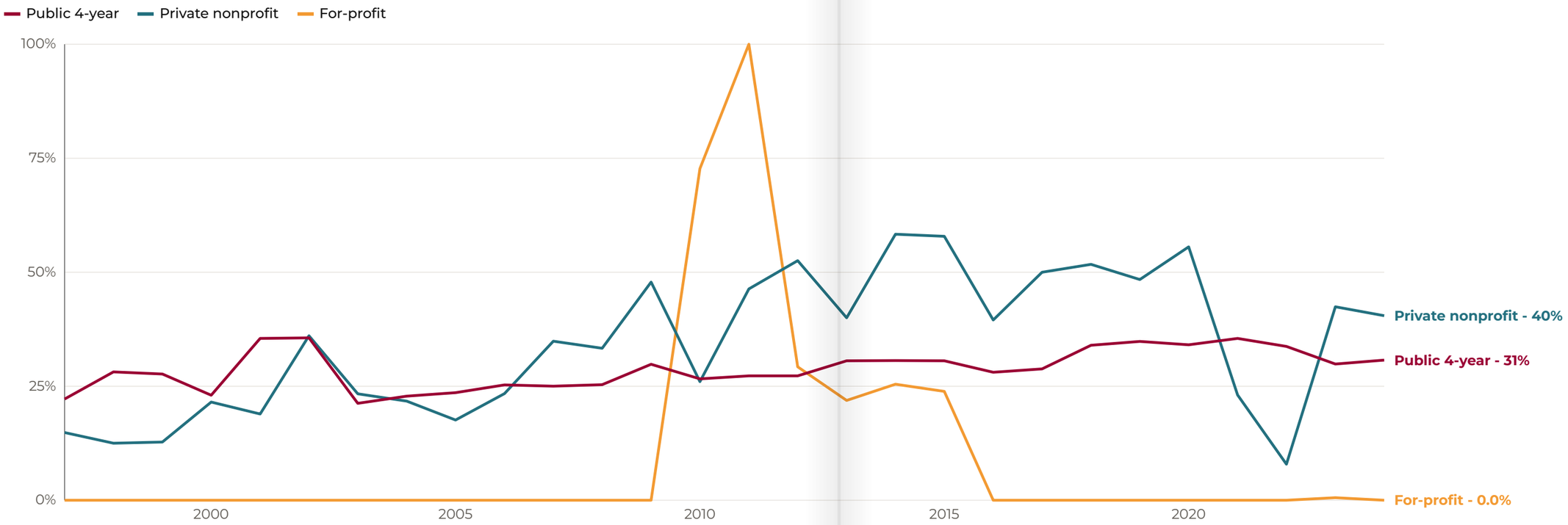
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Alaska ranks 51st of 51 on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 31% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 34 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

31% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Alaska graduated within six years (2024), 33.7 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 51st of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 31%, private nonprofit 40%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 62% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

31%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **51st** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

62%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **5th** of 50 · −5.9 pp since 2015

6.7
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **51st** of 51 · +0.7 since 2015

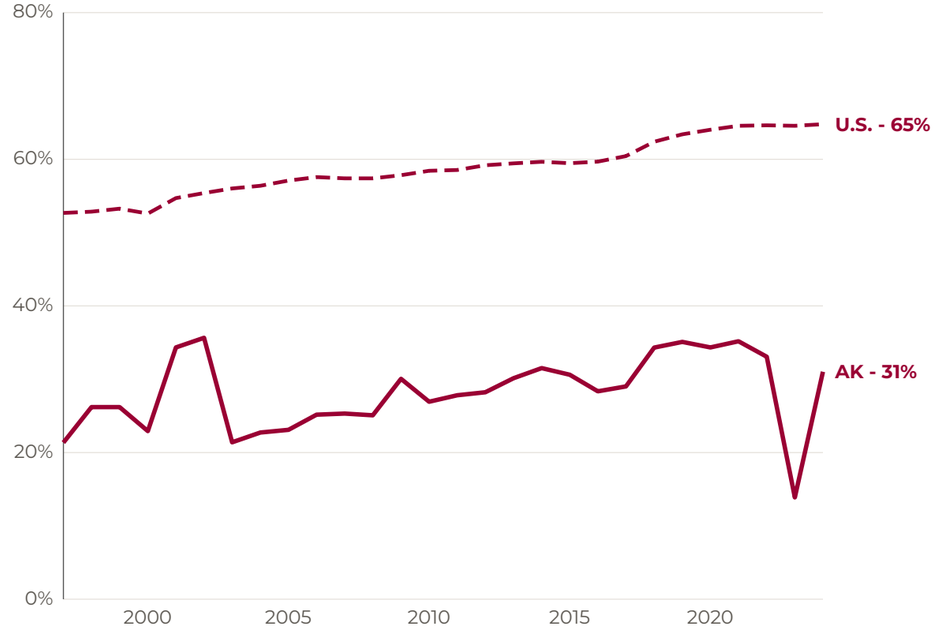
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of Alaska's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Alaska's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (52% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 31% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 17.1 points from 14% in 2023 and up 0.4 points since 2015, when it was 31%.

Figure 35 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

31%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **51st** of 51

62%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **5th** of 50

6.7
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **51st** of 51

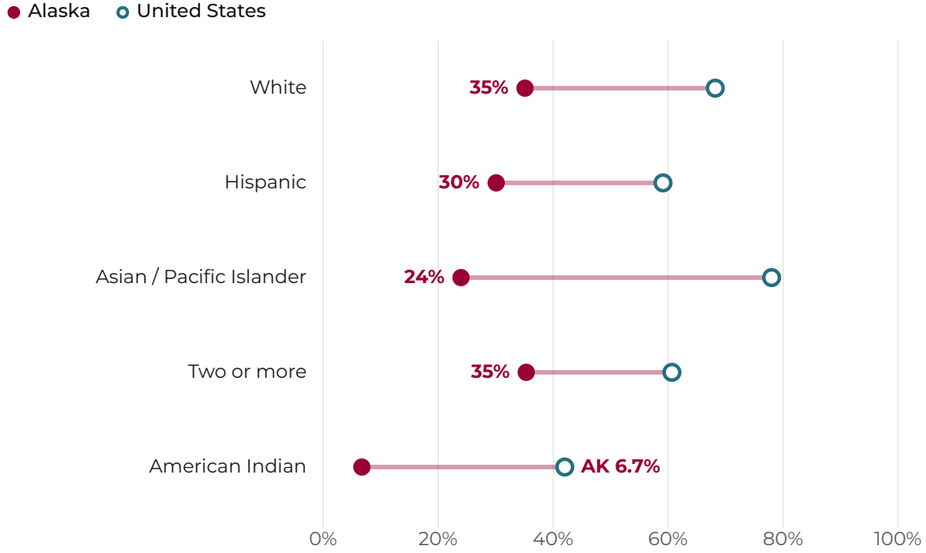
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Alaska's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 35% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 30% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 24% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

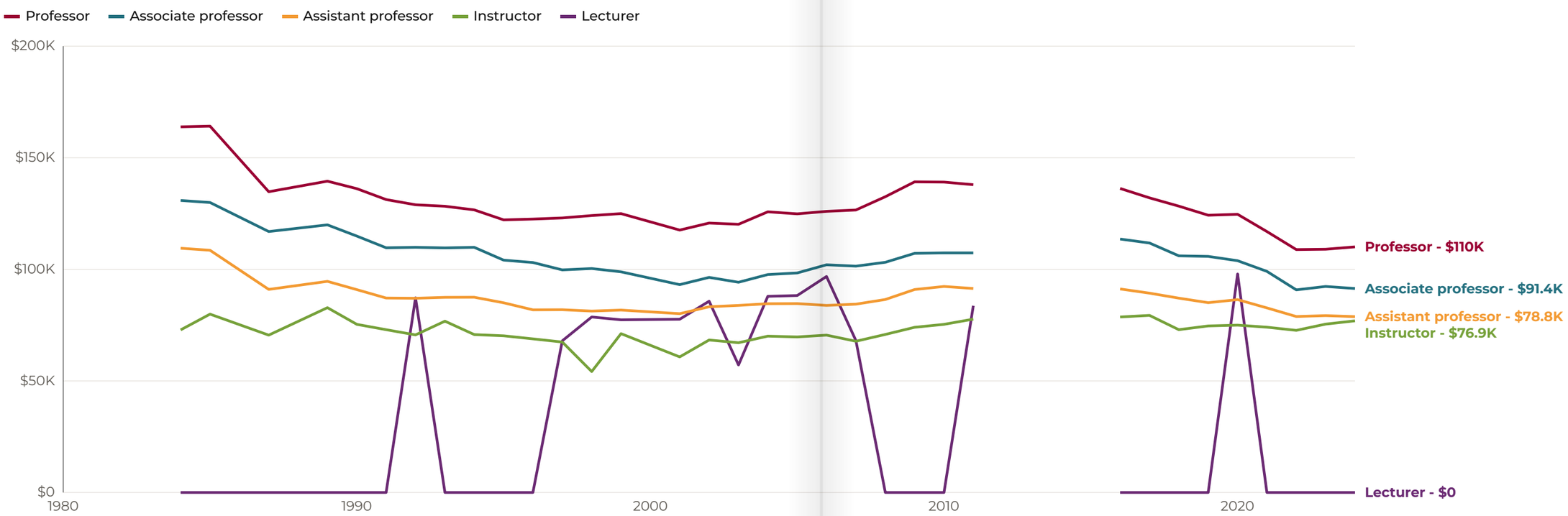
14

SECTION 15

Faculty

Alaska ranks 34th of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $90K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 37 What Do Alaska's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Alaska's institutions earned an average of $90K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 15% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 34th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $110K, associate professors $91.4K, assistant professors $78.8K, instructors $76.9K.

Alaska's institutions had 969 full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 34% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 16% since 2016.

$90K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **34th** of 51 · −16% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

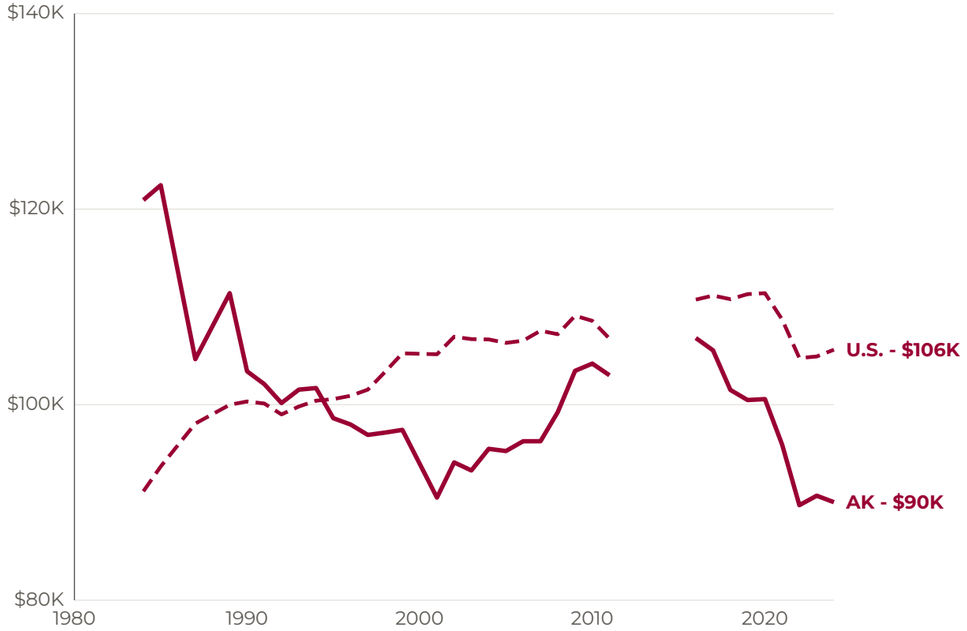
What Do Alaska's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Alaska's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $90K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 34th among the states, down 0.7% from $90.7K in 2023 and down 16% since 2016, when it was $107K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 969 in 2024, up 6.4% from 911 in 2023 and down 34% since 2015, when it was 1.47K.

Figure 38 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$90K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **34th** of 51

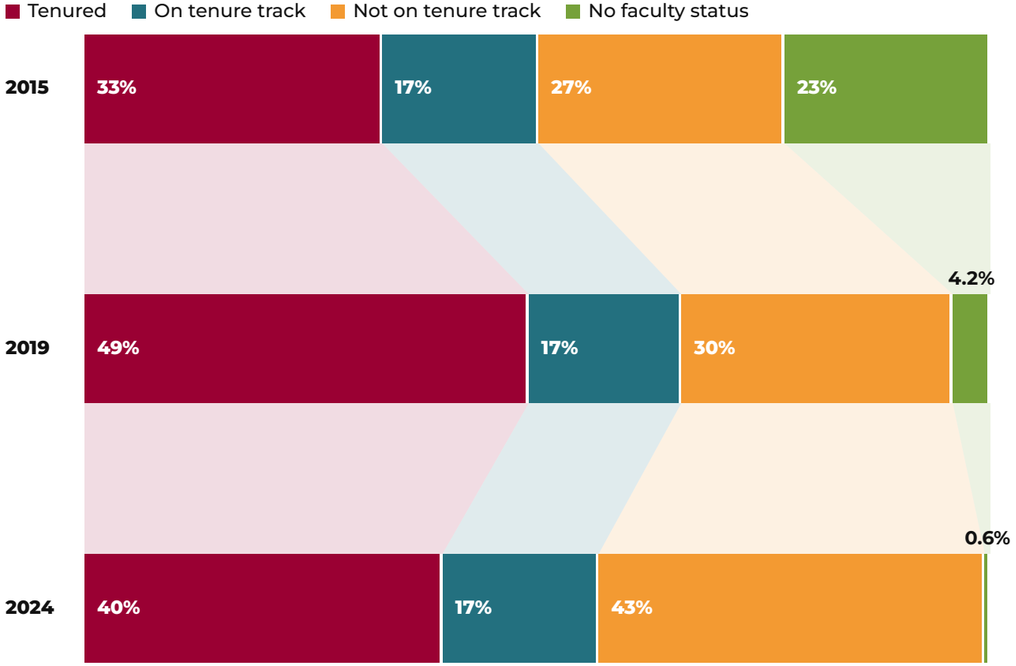
969
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

40%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Alaska's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 40% in 2024, down 2.1 points from 42% in 2023 and up 6.6 points since 2015, when it was 33%.

Figure 39 Tenure Status



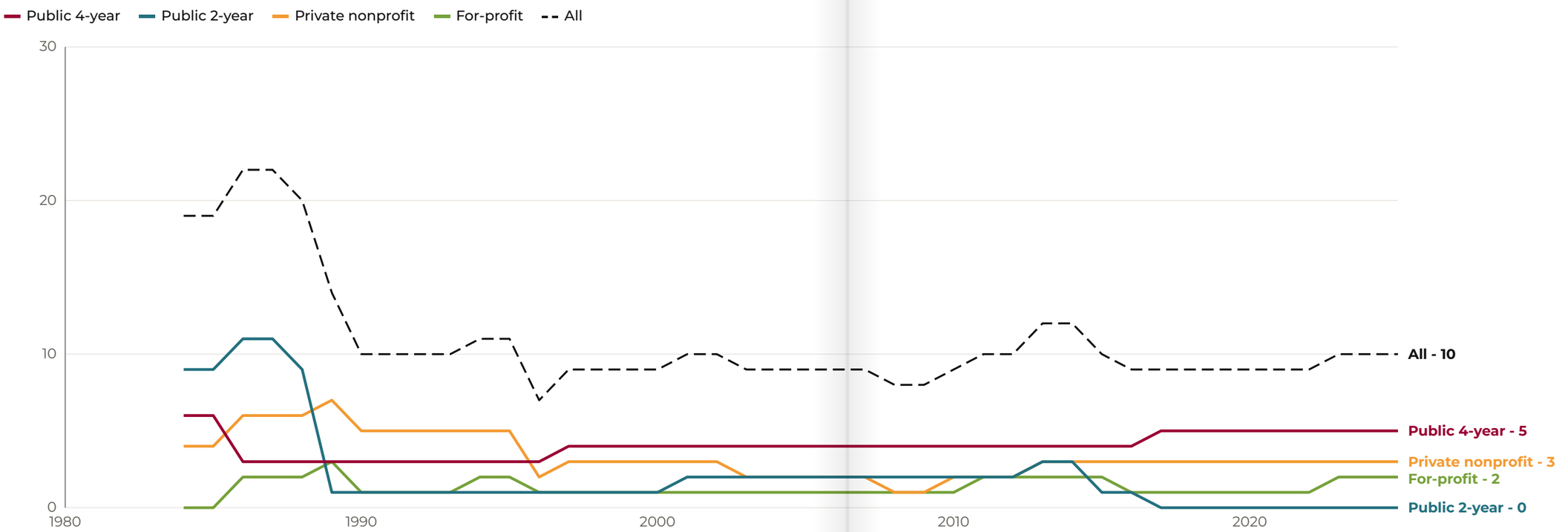
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Alaska ranks 6th of 51 on the share of enrollment at for-profit institutions, at 11% in 2024 against 5.5% for the U.S.

Figure 40 How Many Institutions Does Alaska Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Alaska has 10 degree-granting institutions:5 public 4-year, 0 public 2-year, 3 private nonprofit, 2 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is roughly flat since 2015. 86% of students attend public institutions and 11% attend for-profit ones.

86%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **15th** of 51 · −4.2 pp since 2015

11%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **6th** of 51 · +3.2 pp since 2015

36%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **6th** of 51 · +14.4 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Alaska?

The table lists Alaska's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of Alaska Anchorage (10.5K students), University of Alaska Fairbanks (6.89K students), and Charter College (2.16K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 10 in 2025, and 9 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 9 What Are Alaska's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Alaska Anchorage	**10.5K**	3.3%	127	28%	–
University of Alaska Fairbanks	**6.89K**	9.2%	152	39%	–
Charter College	**2.16K**	–	7	–	–
University of Alaska Southeast	**2K**	1.3%	22	21%	63%
Alaska Pacific University	**593**	1.8%	–	–	96%
Ilisagvik College	**256**	–	–	–	–
Alaska Career College	**250**	–	–	–	–
Alaska Christian College	**46**	–	–	–	–
Alaska Bible College	**38**	–	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

10
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

86%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **15th** of 51

11%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **6th** of 51

36%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **6th** of 51

Share of students at public institutions. The share was 86% in 2024, against 73% for the U.S., 15th among the states, up 0.6 points from 86% in 2023 and down 4.2 points since 2015, when it was 91%.

Share at for-profit institutions. The share was 11% in 2024, against 5.5% for the U.S., 6th among the states, down 0.5 points from 11% in 2023 and up 3.2 points since 2015, when it was 7.4%.

Table 10 Alaska at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
Students at public institutions	91%	86% 2023	**86% 2024**	−4.2 pp	73%	15th
Students at for-profit institutions	7.4%	11% 2023	**11% 2024**	+3.2 pp	5.5%	6th
Students fully online	22%	37% 2023	**36% 2024**	+14.4 pp	27%	6th

Data from NCES, IPEDS.

16

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. In Alaska, 1 institutions counted as public 2-year in 2015 are counted as public 4-year in 2024; they enrolled 256 students (1.1% of the state's total, 1.3% of its public 4-year enrollment). Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

Alaska – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	280	**264**[2024]	−16.5 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#46	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	32%	**22%**[2024]	−10.3 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#41	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	236	**226**[2024]	−10.5 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#50	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	35%	**30%**[2024]	−5.2 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#50	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	260	**246**[2024]	−13.9 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#50	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	31%	**22%**[2024]	−9.7 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#47	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	213	**202**[2024]	−11.2 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#50	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**153**[2011]	–	151	–	#26	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$26.4K	**$23K**[2021]	−13% ▼	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#7	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	76%	**78%**[2022]	+2.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#47	[3]
Public high school graduates	8.04K	**8.28K**[2024]	+3.0% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#47	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$87.3K	**$80.9K**[2022]	−7.3% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#10	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	16.9	**18.3**[2022]	+1.4 ▲	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#6	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	132K	**130K**[2024]	−2.0% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#47	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	43%	**40%**[2023]	−3.6 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#38	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	12%	**11%**[2022]	−1.5 pp ▼	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#11	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	4.7%	**6.4%**[2023]	+1.7 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#24	[3]
High schools offering calculus	21%[2016]	**16%**[2024]	−5.1 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#51	[14]
High schools offering physics	32%[2016]	**24%**[2024]	−7.7 pp ▼	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#51	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	38%[2016]	**25%**[2024]	−12.5 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#51	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	65%[2016]	**49%**[2024]	−15.6 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#51	[14]
High schools offering computer science	31%[2021]	**23%**[2024]	−7.9 pp ▼	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#51	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	20%[2016]	**22%**[2024]	+1.8 pp ▲	56%	0.0 pp	#50	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	5.4%[2021]	**12%**[2024]	+6.3 pp ▲	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#41	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	44%[2016]	**31%[2024]**	−13.3 pp ▼	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#51	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	7.5[2016]	**8.2[2024]**	+0.7 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#51	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	1.9[2016]	**1.1[2024]**	−0.9 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#48	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	4.0[2016]	**2.8[2024]**	−1.2 ▼	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#46	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	15.5[2016]	**6.8[2024]**	−8.7 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#48	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	5.1[2016]	**3.9[2024]**	−1.2 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#32	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	28%	**31%[2025]**	+3.3 pp ▲	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#35	[15]
Fall enrollment	31.4K	**22.7K[2024]**	−28% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#51	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	91%	**86%[2024]**	−4.2 pp ▼	73%	0.0 pp	#15	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	7.4%	**11%[2024]**	+3.2 pp ▲	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#6	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	52%	**52%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#3	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	8.1%	**9.0%[2024]**	+0.9 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	22%	**36%[2024]**	+14.4 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#6	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	41	**35[2025]**	–	59K	+7.3% ▲	#51	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	39	**34[2025]**	–	44.4K	+14% ▲	#51	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.1%	**0.1%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	3	**4[2025]**	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#51	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	1	**0[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#51	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	4.6	**2.9[2025]**	−1.7 ▼	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#46	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	23%	**22%[2025]**	−1.4 pp ▼	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#31	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	1.7%	**3.4%[2025]**	+1.7 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#46	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	9.7%	**8.5%[2025]**	−1.1 pp ▼	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#10	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	1.1%	**0.9%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#30	[4]

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ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	6.1%	**5.8%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	2.4%	**1.1%**[2025]	−1.3 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#38	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	9.5%	**13%**[2025]	+3.9 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#16	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	18%	**17%**[2025]	−1.1 pp ▼	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#37	[4]
STEM share of master's	18%	**13%**[2025]	−5.1 pp ▼	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#45	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	0.6%	**0.2%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	8.8%	**3.9%**[2025]	−4.9 pp ▼	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#37	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.6%	**1.2%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#22	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.6%	**3.1%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#14	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	2.6%	**2.5%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#5	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	4.4%	**8.9%**[2025]	+4.5 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Share of master's in business	16%	**21%**[2025]	+4.8 pp ▲	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#24	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	68%	**63%**[2025]	−5.4 pp ▼	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	7.3%	**11%**[2025]	+4.1 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#31	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#49	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	34%	**11%**[2025]	−22.7 pp ▼	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#26	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	15%	**23%**[2025]	+8.2 pp ▲	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#1	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#48	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	6.1	**6.7**[2025]	+0.7 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#51	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	1.7%[2016]	**1.1%**[2024]	−0.6 pp ▼	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#47	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	18	**10**[2025]	–	117K	2.18× ▲	#51	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[4]

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ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	1.5%	**1.2%**[2024]	−0.3 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#48	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	6.1%	**6.0%**[2024]	0.0 pp	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#46	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	2.1%	**2.3%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	2.0%	**2.6%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#46	[4]
International share of all master's	4.6%	**4.6%**[2025]	0.0 pp	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#48	[4]
International share of STEM master's	14%	**16%**[2025]	+1.7 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#47	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	27%	**18%**[2020]	−9.8 pp ▼	48%	−0.9 pp ▼	#45	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	24%	**5.7%**[2025]	−18.7 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#51	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	29%	**9.1%**[2025]	−19.5 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#51	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	433	**300**[2026]	−31% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#51	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.0%	**0.0%**[2026]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	12%	**8.7%**[2026]	−3.1 pp ▼	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#42	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	9.0%	**4.3%**[2026]	−4.7 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#41	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	**26%**[2026]	−0.5 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#41	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	64	**56**[2026]	−13% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#51	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	192	**199**[2026]	+3.6% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#51	[20]
Active STEM master's students	55	**75**[2026]	+36% ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#51	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	63	**65**[2026]	+3.2% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#51	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	55%	**29%**[2026]	−25.2 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#47	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	73[2017]	**58**[2024]	−21% ▼	–	–	#51	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$14.1M[2018]	**$10M**[2024]	−29% ▼	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#51	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	110[2018]	**56**[2024]	−49% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#51	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.2%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#47	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#50	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.7%**[2024]	+0.3 pp ▲	–	–	#32	[16]

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ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	2.06K	**3.77K**[2025]	+83% ▲	275K	−14% ▼	#26	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	1.09K	**1.04K**[2016]	−4.9% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#48	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	123	**129**[2016]	+4.9% ▲	241K	+2.3% ▲	#50	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	11%	**12%**[2016]	+1.2 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#50	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	26%	**26%**[2016]	−0.4 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#50	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	43	**38**[2016]	–	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#49	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	28%	**21%**[2016]	−6.9 pp ▼	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#51	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$163M	**$276M**[2024]	+69% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#46	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.2%	**0.2%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	57%	**67%**[2024]	+10.8 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#4	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	3.6%	**3.2%**[2024]	−0.5 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#32	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	7.2%	**6.7%**[2024]	−0.5 pp ▼	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#20	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$1.98M	**$2.02M**[2024]	+2.3% ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#51	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$22.9M	**$37.5M**[2024]	+64% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#47	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	1.59K	**3.34K**[2024]	2.10× ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#44	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$208M	**$373M**[2024]	+79% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#41	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$71.9M	**$119M**[2024]	+66% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#43	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$40.2M	**$211M**[2024]	5.24× ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#33	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$15.6M	**$16.1M**[2024]	+2.7% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#50	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$54.3M	**$80.6M**[2025]	+48% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#46	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$69.8M	**$35.3M**[2026]	−34.4 ▼	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#37	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$52.4K[2020]	**$52.2K**[2022]	−0.4% ▼	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#11	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$51K**[2025]	–	$47.5K	–	#13	[15]

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ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES (CONTINUED)							
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$17.8K	**$20.7K**[2024]	+16% ▲	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#7	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$68.6K**[2025]	–	$68.2K	–	#19	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$52.7K**[2025]	–	$51.9K	–	#20	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$72.9K**[2025]	–	$68.1K	–	#6	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	31%	**31%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#51	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	68%	**62%**[2024]	−5.9 pp ▼	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#5	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$7.46K	**$8.04K**[2023]	+7.7% ▲	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#41	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$26.7K	**$28K**[2024]	+5.1% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#2	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	25%	**24%**[2024]	−0.9 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#48	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$107K[2016]	**$90K**[2024]	−16% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#34	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	73%	**57%**[2016]	−16.3 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#6	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	90%	**71%**[2016]	−18.6 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#6	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	75%	**45%**[2016]	−29.5 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#11	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	64%	**48%**[2016]	−16.4 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#7	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	1.16	**1.17**[2016]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#9	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	10	**15**[2016]	–	41.2K	+51% ▲	#50	[21]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−8.3	**+13.4**[2025]	+21.7 ▲	–	–	#4	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	+187	**−44**[2025]	−231.0 ▼	–	–	#30	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	5.4%	**4.5%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	–	–	#3	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	6.2%	**3.2%**[2025]	−3.0 pp ▼	–	–	#12	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	1.39K	**387**[2025]	−72% ▼	–	–	#51	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	92%[2016]	**77%**[2024]	−14.9 pp ▼	–	–	#14	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	−36[2016]	**−27**[2024]	+8.5 ▲	–	–	#50	[4]

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ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	40%[2016]	**55%[2022]**	+15.8 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#3	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	226	**435[2025]**	+92% ▲	914K	−24% ▼	#48	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.0%	**0.0%[2025]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#48	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	65%	**13%[2025]**	−52.2 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#51	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$70K	**$71.9K[2025]**	+2.7% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#49	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	30%	**0.0%[2025]**	−30.1 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#51	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	31	**93[2025]**	–	138K	+75% ▲	#47	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	29%	**1.2%[2024]**	−27.9 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#51	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	3.2%	**16%[2024]**	+12.5 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#8	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	45%	**0.0%[2024]**	−45.2 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#51	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	36%	**7.5%[2025]**	−28.5 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#51	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$71.3K	**$37K[2025]**	−48% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#45	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	1.57K	**1.1K[2024]**	−30% ▼	1.36M	+30% ▲	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.1%	**0.1%[2024]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#46	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	964	**830[2024]**	−14% ▼	819K	+12% ▲	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.1%	**0.1%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#45	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#44	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#41	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.0%	**0.1%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#37	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	23	**54[2026]**	–	127K	+14% ▲	#51	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	23	**160[2026]**	–	268K	+52% ▲	#48	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.0%	**0.0%[2026]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[13]

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ALASKA – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	8.0%	**3.6%**[2026]	−4.4 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#24	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	35%	**59%**[2026]	+24.5 pp ▲	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#2	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	4.3%	**9.3%**[2026]	+4.9 pp ▲	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#46	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	61%	**46%**[2026]	−14.6 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#13	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	18K	**22.9K**[2024]	+27% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#49	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	4.9%	**6.2%**[2024]	+1.4 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#38	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	11%	**10.0%**[2024]	−0.9 pp ▼	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#38	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	6.2%	**6.4%**[2024]	+0.2 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#27	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	5.1%	**5.0%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#20	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	7.9%	**7.6%**[2025]	−0.3 pp ▼	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#29	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	7.6%	**8.3%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#43	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	20.8K	**21.5K**[2025]	+3.5% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#48	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	1.07	**0.99**[2025]	−0.1 ▼	1.00	0.0	#18	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$91.3K	**$106K**[2025]	+17% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#26	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$95.2K[2019]	**$120K**[2024]	+26% ▲	$133K	+24% ▲	#28	[10]
Software developer jobs	500	**530**[2025]	+6.0% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#51	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$55.8K	**$74.7K**[2025]	+34% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#10	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	19	**7**[2025]	–	135K	−0.6% ▼	#51	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#51	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	0.0%	**29%**[2025]	+28.6 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#16	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	25%	**14%**[2025]	−10.7 pp ▼	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#31	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#44	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	15%	**0.0%**[2025]	−14.6 pp ▼	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#51	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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